Together We Strive

Stories of Vibrant Meghalaya Cooperatives

MEGHALAYA
COOPERATIVES

OFFICE OF REGISTRAR
OF COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES
MEGHALAYA

MEGHALAYA
COOPERATIVES

Message

I am pleased that the Office of The Registrar of Cooperative Societies has come up with a Coffee Table Book Titled -' Together We Strive - Stories of Vibrant Meghalaya Cooperatives.' Cooperatives need to be encouraged and the Cooperative Movement in the state has to be celebrated.

This publication is a tribute to our enterprising Cooperators who inspite of odds are striving to improve their own lives and are contributing to betterment of their communities.

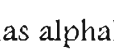
Smti. R. V. Suchiang, IAS
Commissioner & Secretary
Cooperation Department
Government. of Meghalaya

Logo EXPLAINED

MEGHALAYA
COOPERATIVES

The logo has two elements:

The first element comprises intertwining threads and strands woven into each other symbolizing harmony, illustrating cooperative bonds, seamless integration and union, which are the underlying cooperative values and principles. Intertwining strands thrusting upwards, indicating aspiration to reach for the sky, in the image of hills sloping upwards, also reminiscent of the three hilly regions of Meghalaya - the geographical space which the 1391 Cooperatives of the State inhabit.

The second element has alphabets '  ' at the bottom and refers to Meghalaya Cooperatives. The styling of the alphabets is done to evoke the Cooperatives idyll of people working together in harmony.

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INTRODUCTION

The only thing that will redeem mankind is cooperation - Lord Bertrand Russell

"Cooperative enterprises build a better world!!" - That's the slogan for the International Year of Cooperatives (IYC) 2012 Celebrations. The slogan captures many ideas-the idea that the current order of things is not good enough, the idea that there is hope and the idea that cooperatives and cooperation shall continue to be relevant.

The current global economic development paradigm based on the mantra of growth and competition has led to phenomenal wealth creation in the last couple of decades. The poor and the marginalized, however, do not seem to be enjoying the fruits of growth as much as their better off brethren. Growth without equity is creating a global order where the income gap between the haves and the have-nots is becoming wider by the day. It is in this context that Cooperatives based on the principles of self-help and mutual-help and strongly rooted in the common good have a strong relevance and the United Nations has very appropriately chosen 2012 as the 'International Year of Cooperatives' to give a fillip to the cooperative movement across the globe.

The Cooperative movement in India is more than a century old. It had an important role in bringing food sufficiency through the green revolution, in building up a network for distribution of new varieties of seeds, fertilizers and cash credit and in creating an environment of participation and hope among the people. Beginning with Amul in Gujarat, it took extraordinary strides in the dairy sector too. However, the politicization of Cooperatives, the inability of Cooperative leadership to adapt to the changing times and the thrust of the government on formation and nurturing of alternate people's institutions like Self Help Groups (SHGs) has led to erosion/decline in the Cooperative Movement. The share of the Primary Agriculture Credit Societies (PACS) in the total agricultural credit disbursed is steadily reducing and many of the sectoral cooperatives are non-performing with negative net worth and large accumulated NPAs. In response, the Government amended the Constitution and brought in structural reforms in the formation and operation of Cooperatives and implemented the Revival Package for Short Term Cooperative Credit Structure (STCCS) and the Handloom Weavers Reform and Revival package to infuse capital into and to cleanse the balance sheets of Cooperative Societies. These initiatives should go a long way in revitalizing the Cooperative sector in the country.

In Meghalaya the political, social, economic and cultural life of the citizens in villages is guided by community level governance institutions-Dorbar Shnongs, Maharis etc., which to some extent embody the Cooperative principles in their functioning. The rural communities are organized around the principles of egalitarianism and cooperative spirit pervades every aspect of community life. The Cooperative movement in the state is more than half a century old and has a total membership of 170,000. Some of the Cooperative societies of the state are functioning for many decades and have been rendering very useful service to their members and their communities. The institutional framework for many of the success stories of the state in the sectors of handlooms, handicrafts, food processing, fisheries, livestock, dairy, transport and marketing is a cooperative society. Products like Urlong Tea, Eri silk products from Umden/Diwon,

Handicrafts of Mowkendeng, Honey of Khadarshnong which are household names in Meghalaya are all produced and marketed by Cooperative societies. The Dairy Cooperatives of East Khasi Hills and Nongpoh districts produce a significant portion of the milk consumed in Shillong city.

Inspite of such successes, the story of Meghalaya Cooperatives is far from being picture perfect. For instance, only 60% of the 1391 registered Cooperative Societies are today functional and a large number of the PACS are only functioning at sub-optimal levels.

However, the State Government realizes that with investments in capacity building and through providing the required hand-holding support, Cooperatives can be run more effectively and be geared toward promoting collective well-being. Accordingly, coinciding with the International Year of Cooperatives, a new Cooperative bill that provides a more enabling environment for formation and management of Cooperative societies has been framed. Secondly, thrust is being given to bring more youth and women into the cooperative fold and to revive non-functioning societies, which are potentially viable. Thirdly, new type of Cooperative Societies called Integrated Village Cooperative Societies (IVCS) that will support individual and community enterprises are being experimented with. Lastly, greater thrust is being laid on capacity building of the members and office bearers of Cooperative Societies to run Cooperative enterprises professionally and to diversify businesses.

The current publication-*'Together We Strive-Stories of Vibrant Meghalaya Cooperatives'* is an attempt at showcasing 44 of our best functioning Cooperative Societies and is aimed at promoting better understanding about the Cooperative Sector. It should also serve to boost the self-image and confidence levels of both the Cooperators and the officials of the department.

The task of putting together the information and pictures of all the Cooperative Societies and presenting it in this current form was stupendous and would not have been possible without the commitment and hard work of many individuals. I should place on record my sincere appreciation and gratitude to them- Mrs. R. V. Suchiang, Commissioner and Secretary, Cooperation Department, Government of Meghalaya for her encouragement and support; the students of National Institute of Fashion technology (NIFT), Shillong for so tellingly capturing the essence of the cooperative societies through their lenses; Kong Wanrie Booth, Director NIFT and Dorji, Associate Professor, NIFT for their enthusiasm and interest in the project; Kong Renee Lulam for painstakingly penning down the stories twice (thanks to her computer crash!!); Kong Iora, Bah Lyngkhoi, Kong Rimecca, Bah Lanong, Kong Mandia, Bah Teibor and Kong Darry from Office; Bryan from DIPR for the designs and layouts; Vikram, our printer for motivating me to complete the project when I almost gave up; lastly and most importantly, to all the Cooperators who have crafted success worthy of being showcased.

I am certain that this publication will create a greater sense of pride amongst the cooperative societies and will contribute to strengthening the Cooperative Movement in Meghalaya.

D. Vijay Kumar
Registrar of Cooperative Societies
Government of Meghalaya

Credit and Banking

COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES

THE KASHARIPARA SERVICE CO-OPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.
DEPOSIT MOBILISATION CENTRE
SAVINGS ACCOUNT PAY- IN- SLIP
CASH
HALLIDAY GANJ
.....200
A/C.....
Ledger Folio.....
Particulars of notes
1000 X
500 X
100 X
Paid the Credit of.....
Rupees.....
By.....
This must be signed by the Cashier and the Manager
Date.....200
A/c.No.....
(Paid to the Kasharipara Service Co-Operative Society Ltd. Hallidayganj)
for Credit of.....
Rupees.....
Particulars of notes
1000 X
500 X
100 X

PROFILE

Name	:	Kasharipara Service Cooperative Society Ltd. Hallidayganj, West Garo Hills
Year of Formation	:	1957
Membership	:	Male 1107 Female 319 Total 1426
Chairman	:	Shri. M. Islam
Secretary	:	Shri. S. A. Ahmed
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 14,42,155
Business Turnover	:	₹ 69,14,269
Working Result	:	₹ 14,27,923

KASHARIPARA SERVICE COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

Kasharipara Service Cooperative Society, located at Hallidayganj, West Garo Hills, was registered in 1956 by small and marginal agriculturists. It was reorganized under the Master Plan in 1978. Their area of operation currently covers forty five villages.

The co-operative provides agricultural credit through refinancing, usually borrowing from Meghalaya Co-operative Apex Bank, and lending to farmers in need of credit. An additional interest margin of two percent is charged under this scheme to meet the co-operative's running costs and overhead expenses.

The co-operative also supplies agricultural material to members, and markets the agricultural produce of members and other farmers. They used to supply consumer goods, but discontinued. They started a deposit mobilisation scheme from which loans are made out to petty businessmen and other members. In 2002, under the ICDP Scheme, the co-operative introduced its Mini-Bank Counter, where deposits and loans are made. The counter collects daily deposit from its members for a term of one year.

The co-operative provides non-agricultural loans to depositors from their own deposits in the mini-bank. The mini-bank has advanced non-agricultural loans to two hundred and thirty-one depositor-members already. The co-operative's sole income comes from this business. Since starting the Mini-Bank Counter, they began earning a profit. The co-operative had formerly incurred considerable losses, but their last audit report shows a substantial net surplus.

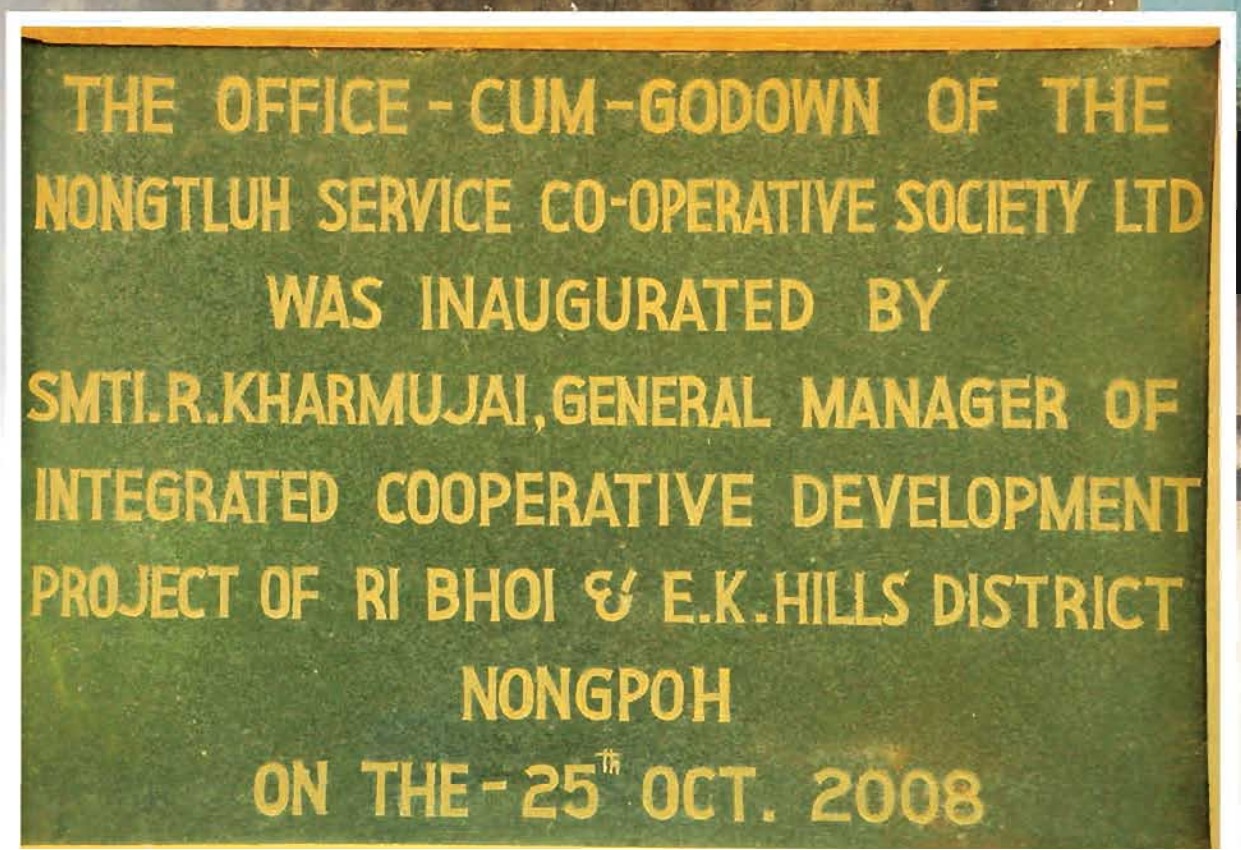
The co-operative owns land measured at 23040 square feet acquired for ₹ 6000 in 1978, now valued at approximately a crore in the market. They constructed a 150 Metric Tonne godown, funded by the NCDC Loan and Subsidy Scheme in 1981. Under the ICDP Scheme in 2002, they constructed a two storied building for their office-cum-retail outlet. The first floor houses the co-operative's offices and the Mini-Bank Counter. The ground floor is rented out to members. The co-operative is staffed by seven employees.

NONGTLUH SERVICE COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Nongtluh Service Co-operative Society, headquartered at Diwon is a co-operative of marginal farmers across thirty two villages with the aim to collectively address the gaps and issues they encounter, gain access to goods and services otherwise not readily available, increase bargaining power, share costs of new technology, gain access to new markets reducing risks associated with new enterprise, obtain new services, bulk purchase, and provide benefit to the larger community in general.

The co-operative began its operation by providing agricultural loans to its members through concessional credit availed from Meghalaya Co-operative Apex Bank. They have never defaulted in refunding loans, which earned them the bank's Best Performance Award in 2007. The co-operative also markets ginger and broomstick bought from farmers under its area of operation. They extended their activity in 2009 to a Deposit Mobilisation Unit or Mini Banking facilities at their headquarters with aid received from the National Co-operative Development Corporation through their Integrated Co-operative Development Project scheme. The Unit accepts deposits from members and non-members alike in the form of Saving Deposits, Fixed Deposits and Recurring Deposits. It also issues soft loans to members, charging a simple interest of 9% per annum. To avoid confusion with the various transactions of the Deposit Mobilisation Unit, the co-operative opened a separate bank account meant solely for the Unit with the Meghalaya Co-operative Apex Bank, Nongpoh Branch in August 2010. The Unit's transactions are handled by two salaried staff.

Some years after the co-operative was formed in 1971, they constructed a small godown with financial aid from the Government in the form of loan and subsidy. Subsequently, in 2007, the society was selected for financial assistance under the Integrated Cooperative Development Project funded by NCDC. With this assistance, the co-operative has its own Office-cum-godown with some basic amenities at Diwon.

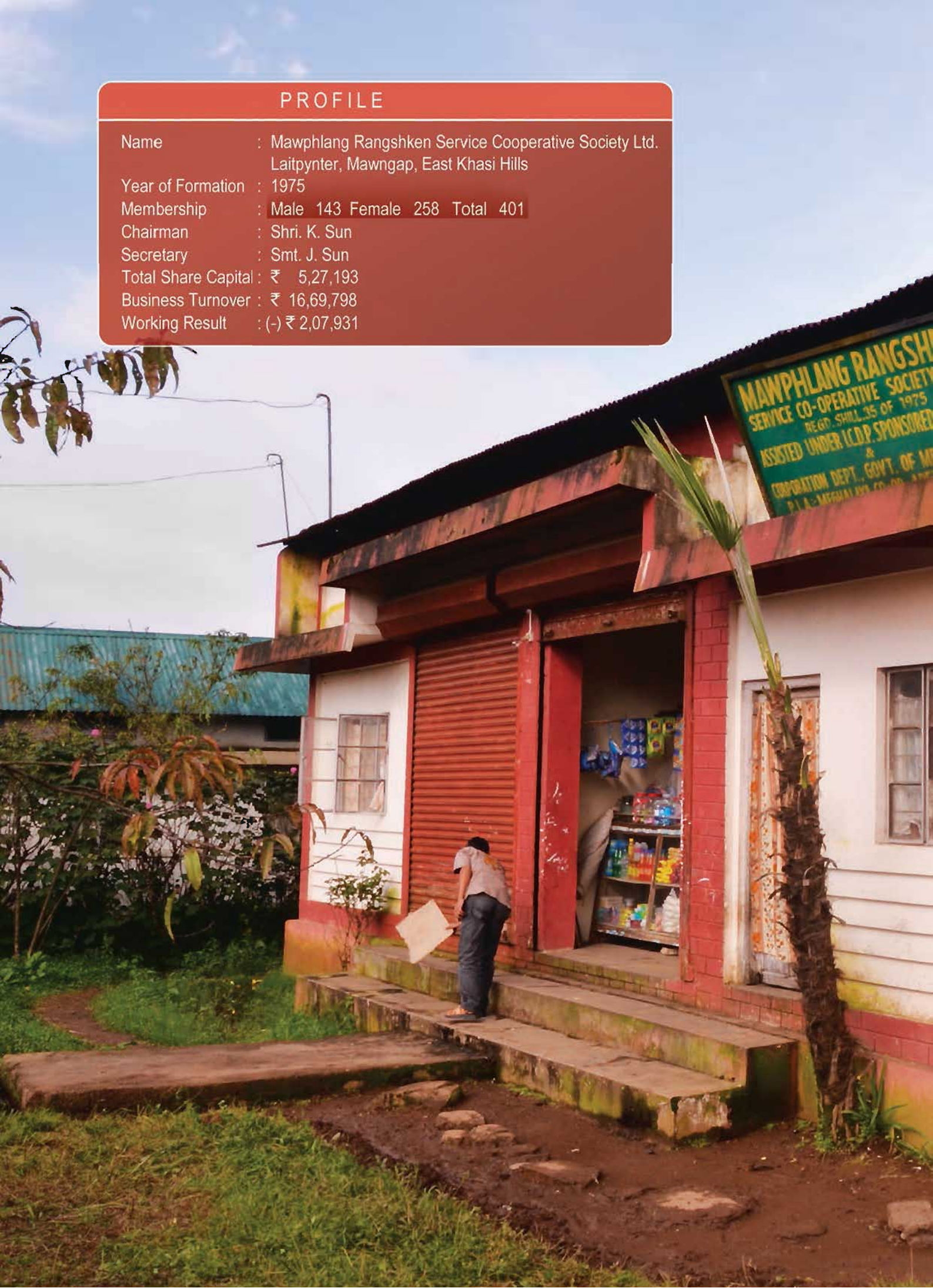


PROFILE

Name	:	Nongtluh Service Cooperative Society Ltd. Diwon, Nongpoh, Ri Bhoi
Year of Formation	:	1971
Membership	:	Male 95 Female 34 Total 129
Chairman	:	Shri. H. Makri
Secretary	:	Shri. L. S. Khymdeit
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 11,17,160
Business Turnover	:	₹ 29,55,036
Working Result	:	₹ 7,000

PROFILE

Name	:	Mawphlang Rangshken Service Cooperative Society Ltd. Laitpynter, Mawngap, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1975
Membership	:	Male 143 Female 258 Total 401
Chairman	:	Shri. K. Sun
Secretary	:	Smt. J. Sun
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 5,27,193
Business Turnover	:	₹ 16,69,798
Working Result	:	(-) ₹ 2,07,931



MAWPHLANG RANGSHKEN SERVICE COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Mawphlang Rangskhen Service Co-operative Society located at Laitpynter Marbisu BPO, Mawngap operates across thirty one villages with a focus on the financial and economic enablement of farmers and agriculturists in these villages. Headquartered at Mawphlang, twenty four kilometres from Shillong, the co-operative was registered in 1975; in the first four years of its existence, the original members went about enrolling farmers in the villages as members into the co-operative so they could access the agricultural loan facilities available to co-operative members. From 1979, the co-operative started extending agricultural loans to member farmers through Meghalaya Co-operative Apex Bank. The initial amount was ₹ 250/- to each farmer. That amount gradually increased through the years, and today, the bank's upper credit limit for each farmer, through the co-operative, is ten thousand rupees. The loan is also available to non-member farmers from villages within the co-operative's area of operation.

In 1988 the co-operative diversified its activities by opening a consumer shop to distribute essential commodities, appointing a sales woman with a monthly salary. Initially, commodities had to be distributed shop to shop in the local market, and money from sales was then collected by the sales woman in the evening. The store is in full operation now, and also sells fertiliser to farmers. In 1996 the co-operative took a plot of land on lease at Laitpynter village for 40 years from Kong Bibian Kharkongor, a co-operative member, where a godown-cum-office was constructed through the ICDP scheme. The co-operative conducts awareness programmes on the latest knowledge on agriculture, livestock rearing, and loans available to them.

In collaboration with Meghalaya Co-operative Apex Bank, the co-operative has also initiated a deposit mobilisation unit at its office at Laitpynter, to enable members to save and invest without having to go too far. The co-operative employs two women.

Handloom
COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES

NONGTLUH WOMEN WEAVING COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Nongtluh Women's Weaving Cooperative Society is situated at Umden Diwon, Raid Nongtluh, Ri-Bhoi District, and falls under the Umling Development Block. The main objective of the co-operative is to take up activities that promote the economic, social and cultural interest of its members in the Handloom sector. The co-operative consists of forty five women folk artisans and weavers. They are known for their silk weaving tradition and culture, producing fine silk fabric. The co-operative is also particularly known for its fabric made of hand spun Eri-a silk yarn-in traditional colours.

Eri is woven in and around Ri-Bhoi District on its own and along with other yarns. The colours have been produced traditionally and are suitable for natural yarns. Raw materials are available locally and a vast range of products can be made with use of Azofree and vegetables dyes. The co-operative has proposed that for the development in marketing of the products guidance and assistance of MEGHALOOM, the Apex State Level Handloom Society would be sought, besides actively engaging with Departments like Handloom, Sericulture & Weaving.

Since its inception, the co-operative has been engaged in Weaving, Spinning and Dyeing. Besides that, they also impart practical training to members in the art of weaving, spinning and dyeing. The secretary of the co-operative is well qualified and trained, vastly experienced in hand woven products. She is a repository of traditional handloom knowledge and heritage of the area.

The ICDP Scheme has greatly leveraged and consolidated their business, facilitating their work through provision of a permanent work-shed, looms and a new designing machine. Through the ICDP fund, the co-operative has opened a showroom to sell their products and fabrics. They have started repayment of the loan financed by ICDP, and plan to complete repayments within a period of two years.

PROFILE

Name	:	Nongtluh Women Weaving Cooperative Society Ltd. Umden Diwon, Raid Nongtluh, Ri Bhoi
Year of Formation	:	1977
Members	:	Male 0 Female 45 Total 45
Chairman	:	Smt. T. Rynshon
Secretary	:	Smt. T. Tmung
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 14,10,020
Business Turnover	:	₹ 8,79,370
Working Result	:	₹ 33,166

PROFILE

Name	:	Diwon Handloom Cotton Khadi & Village Industrial Cooperative Society Ltd, Umden Diwon, Ri Bhoi
Year of Formation	:	1996
Membership	:	Male 0 Female 45 Total 45
Chairman	:	Smt. S. Syngkli
Secretary	:	Smt. T. Tmung
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 12,67,260
Business Turnover	:	₹ 4,92,420
Working Result	:	(-) ₹ 37,720

DIWON HANDLOOM COTTON KHADI AND VILLAGE INDUSTRIAL CO-OPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Diwon Handloom Cotton Khadi and Village Industrial Co-operative Society is situated at Diwon Village, near Umden in Ri Bhoi District. Apart from weavers, the co-operative includes women folk artisans. The co-operative focuses on promoting the economic, social and cultural interests of its members in the handloom sector. The co-operative engages in weaving, spinning and natural dyeing. Their earliest activity involved procurement and supply of yarn for weavers, who may or may not be members of the co-operative. Gradually, the co-operative began to procure cocoons to produce their own yarn. They dedicate themselves to handloom weaving of traditional clothes like the Ryndia, a shawl woven from raw silk for both men and women.

The co-operative is a knowledge repository of the art of producing natural dyes. Traditionally limited to three colours, the co-operative discovered ways to produce another twelve colours. Using no more than raw material available locally, the dyes are produced solely from organic sources. Their organic dyes and processing methods have been recognised by the Crafts Council of India. It has now become an area of study and research for design students, and a point of interest for foreign visitors.

Under the District Handloom Office, the co-operative Secretary, Kong Thran Tmung imparts training on the art of weaving and design to other interested individuals and groups. Their products are sold in local markets and emporiums and also outside the state at exhibitions organized by the Sericulture Department. They now have a permanent workshed with looms and a machine to facilitate designing. The infrastructure and facilities provided under the ICDP Scheme, enables the co-operative to increase production to meet the demand, producing designs and products that respond to the requirements of the market, while retaining their originality and unique traditions.

BANGALKATA HANDLOOM WEAVERS COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The fabric woven in Garo Hills is well known for its unique designs, and colour combinations. Today, with modern inputs, gifted artisans produce colorful fabrics for furnishing, bed spreads, shirts, as well as silk kota saris, cotton jamdani saris, buti saris, buti long length dress material, lungis, pachra, laisumphi, acrylic shawls, which are in demand both within and outside the state. The scale of production varies, depending on the type of loom used, type of cloth produced, materials used, and the pattern involved.

In 1964, weavers from Bangalkata, Kalapani, Chandigiri and Khakaimari villages came together and registered the Bangalkata Handloom Weavers Co-operative Society for their economic and social growth. Their area of operation now covers twelve villages. In 1982, they became a member of the Meghalaya Supervision and Cadre Management Co-operative Society, Shillong. Anima Mann was appointed Secretary of the co-operative by them, and she has held this office till date.

The co-operative started with just two looms; now they have thirteen looms distributed among eighty five members. Earlier, the co-operative produced mekhla chadar, gamchcha, daksari, bedcover and the like. With time, the demand for other traditional fabric and clothing arose and weavers began to additionally produce dakbandha, traditional waistcoats, neck-ties, woolen shawls, baby-wear and more. The co-operative purchases necessary raw-materials from the local markets and government approved dealer at Tura. Their products are exhibited at different district and state level exhibitions. They feel the demand for traditional hand woven fabric is decreasing with modern technology and the introduction of acrylic fabric. The co-operative however holds on to the tradition of hand-woven fabric and promotes it. It specializes in the traditional patterns and designs of Garo Hills. The co-operative has an elected managing committee which determines their business plan and other activities. They are staffed by one salaried woman employee.

PROFILE

Name	:	Bangalkata Handloom Weavers Cooperative Society Ltd., Bangalkata, West Garo Hills
Year of Formation	:	1964
Membership	:	Male 0 Female 85 Total 85
Chairman	:	Smt. H. Sangma
Secretary	:	Smt. A. Mann
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 8,57,556
Business Turnover	:	₹ 88,033
Working Result	:	(-) ₹ 51,778

Handicraft
COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES

NONGPRIANG HANDICRAFT WEAVERS AND MARKETING COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Nongpriang Handicraft Weavers and Marketing Cooperative Society came into existence in the year 2006, created by crafts-persons and weavers from Nongpriang. Located at Cherrapunjee, their priority is to make economic progress through handicraft and weaving, a knowledge and practice passed down to them from their ancestors. The village is also endowed with raw materials such as cane and bamboo planted by them almost every year. It is inhabited by about 70 families who mainly practice agriculture and basket making; daily wage labour is an alternative livelihood activity.

Since registering, the co-operative has organized a number of workshops and programmes in Sohra Sub-Division on cane and bamboo related knowledge and activities, involving other grassroot organizations, self-help groups and was supported by different government departments. They make it a point to network with community based organizations in the area, extending mutual support in terms of knowledge, training and information. Their handicraft and woven products include table lamps, bamboo murahs or woven seats, folding tables and chairs, traditional fiber nets, local combs, magazine racks, household decorations, flowers, toys, drums, arrows, woodcraft, souvenirs, fine miniature baskets and others. Their products are hugely popular, going by the demand and size of their customer base.

Capacity building is important to them; members frequently attend training programmes ranging from weaving and handicraft to rural development, rural industries, and bookkeeping. They have gotten themselves regularly audited by a Chartered Accountant for five years in a row. A proposal has been made by members of the co-operative for a retail outlet at Mawir, on the main road from Sohra to Shella. The location has been suggested keeping in mind that it is a tourist spot, it is on the main road and it is at the centre of Cherrapunjee. The co-operative currently engages twelve employees paying daily wage.

PROFILE

Name	:	Nongpriang Handicraft Weavers and Marketing Cooperative Society Ltd., Nongpriang, Sohra
Year of Formation	:	2007
Membership	:	Male 14 Female 03 Total 17
Chairman	:	Shri. B. Shabong
Secretary	:	Shri. W. Khongphai
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 4,04,460
Business Turnover	:	₹ 39,600
Working Result	:	₹ 1,282

PROFILE

Name	:	Kenbah Kenmynsaw Handicraft & Multipurpose Cooperative Society Ltd. Kenbah, Mawsynram, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	2007
Membership	:	Male 10 Female 10 Total 20
Chairman	:	Smt. S. Kynter
Secretary	:	Smt. D. Pdahkasiej
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 4,25,370
Business Turnover	:	₹ 1,96,721
Working Result	:	₹ 67,771

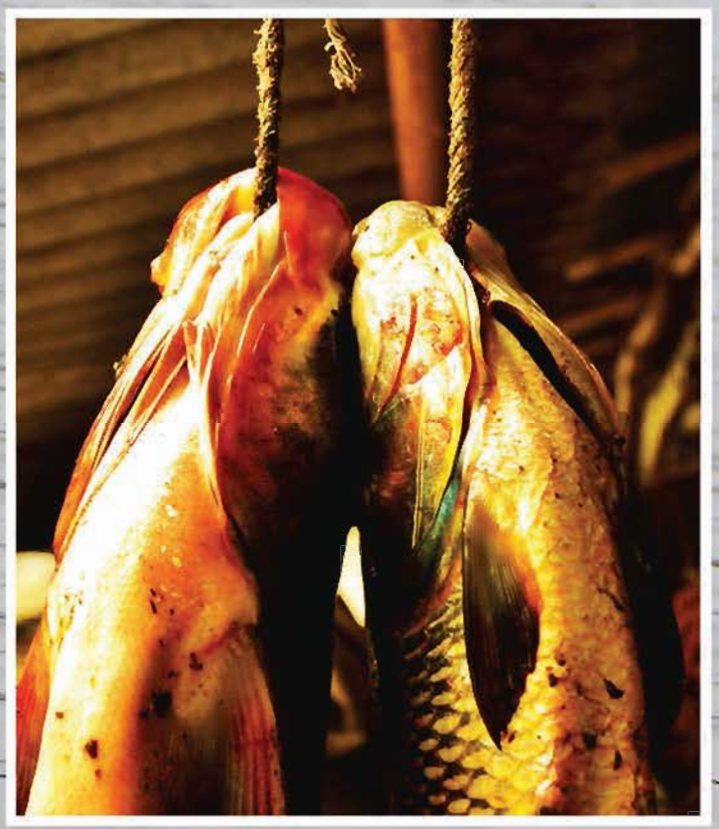
KENBAH KENMYNSAW HANDICRAFT AND MULTIPURPOSE COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Kenbah Kenmynsaw Handicraft and Multipurpose Cooperative Society, whose area of operation comprises Kenbah and Kenmynsaw villages under Mawsynram Development Block, 62Kms from Shillong, was registered in 2007. The main activity of the co-operative is the production of handicraft products, marketing these at emporiums, other sale outlets, and exhibitions in the state and other parts of the country. The co-operative also markets handicraft products produced by other artisans in its area of operation.

What is unique about the cooperative is the skill in crafting products without using any modern machinery or technology. Members use simple tools like knives and traditional blades to split bamboo and cane. The split bamboo and cane are then woven into various well finished handicraft products like baskets, flower pots, and a number of household decorating items. The people of Kenbah Kenmynsaw have traditionally been associated with handicraft making. Earlier, handicraft was a leisure activity, but today it is seen as a sustainable livelihood alternative. The promotion of handicraft increased their earnings and of the community in the co-operative's area of operation; handicraft generates income throughout the year, whereas forest and horticulture produce is seasonal.

Members also get to attend different exhibitions held within the state and throughout the country which broadens their outlook and skills through learning about other types and techniques of handicraft making; through interaction with artisans from other parts of the state or the country who also participate in these exhibitions. Since most of the people of Kenbah and Kenmynsaw are well versed in the art of handicraft making, the cooperative has served well for the community at large. The co-operative encourages local artisans and the handicrafts made are bought and marketed by the co-operative. As a result, local artisans get to earn additional incomes from their craft.

Fishery
COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES



PROFILE

Name	:	Kodaldhowa Mashpala Fishery Cooperative Society Ltd. Kodaldhowa, West Garo Hills
Year of Formation	:	1956
Membership	:	Male 17 Female 04 Total 21
Chairman	:	Shri. K. R. Hajong
Secretary	:	Shri. S. R. Hajong
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 5,02,942
Business Turnover	:	₹ 2,03,005
Working Result	:	₹ 1,02,367

KODALDHOWA MASHPALA FISHERY COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

Kodaldhowa Fishery Cooperative Society, formerly known as the Kodaldhowa Maspala (Fishery) Somobai Somity located at Kodalhawa, West Garo Hills was first formed as a village initiative to clean up an abandoned pond that had become an unhygienic place due to mosquito breeding.

The old abandoned beel (water tank) was fourteen bighas and eight lessas in measurement. Grass and weeds covered the beel. This made habitat of its adjacent areas almost impossible creating unhygienic conditions. In 1955, the villagers of Kodalhawa decided to clear the tank and put the beel to good use. It was decided that a fishery venture be started at the beel, and benefits out of this joint effort be shared. A unanimous agreement that they organise themselves into a fishery society in the fold of cooperative sector was made. They then appealed to the Garo Hills District Council, in 1956, to lease the land to the co-operative so that this purpose would be served, and the natural wealth and property of the land be saved. Members were keen and everyone was ready to contribute physical labour and time towards the achievement of their goal. The Kodaldhowa Maspala Somobhai Somity was registered in 1957.

Profits from the fishery pond have been slow as fish is a perishable commodity and the co-operative was not equipped with proper marketing and storage facilities; each year, members have to sell the fish at the will of middlemen. This past year, however, they garnered significant profit from participating in a bidding auction to whole- sellers. More recently, the co-operative has diversified its business into areca nut. Four men are employed with salary. Every year since 1990, the co-operative contributes ₹ 5,000 to the sole school in the village as support.

KUDENGRIM FISHERY COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Kudengrim Fishery Cooperative Society, registered in 1998 and located at Kudengrim Village in West Jaintia Hills was formed by like-minded individuals with an interest to voluntarily associate themselves in the aim of the socio-economic development of its members, the community, and the area in general. To this end, the co-operative rears and sells fish as its primary activity.

The co-operative began with just two fish ponds and twenty members. From 2007 onwards, the co-operative has represented the Sub-Division in the District and the State level exhibitions, as well as at Aqua Expos. Members participate in trainings conducted by the Department of Fisheries both within and outside the state. The co-operative maintains healthy ties with the different government departments and co-operates well with them in all respects.

At present, the co-operative consists of thirty five members who are all men; they have eight ponds. To enhance the business bulk of the co-operative, the Office of The Registrar of Co-operative Societies extended them financial assistance in the form of Share Capital Contribution. Apart from this, they have also received assistance through centrally sponsored schemes like the Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (RKVY) through the Department of Agriculture, and others. With support from these, construction of three more fish ponds is in progress. In the last few years, they have sold fish from their ponds at the different markets in the District.

The co-operative supplies fingerlings of different kinds to members and non-members alike. With help from the co-operative, members and other people are able to get fingerlings for their individual ponds as well. In keeping with their aim of overall community development in forming this co-operative, the Society has also undertaken projects like road and pavement construction. The co-operative engages six men and two women as staff, paying them an employment salary.

PROFILE

Name	:	Kudengrim Fishery Cooperative Society Ltd. Kudengrim, Amlarem
Year of Formation	:	1998
Membership	:	Male 35 Female 0 Total 35
Chairman	:	Shri. H. Pohtam
Secretary	:	Shri. S. Pohtam
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 13,81,075
Business Turnover	:	₹ 5,66,939
Working Result	:	₹ 2,08,252

PROFILE

Name	:	Phlang Mawsyrpad Fishery Cooperative Society Ltd. Phlang Mawsyrpad, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1996
Membership	:	Male 70 Female 17 Total 87
Chairman	:	Shri. P. Kynter
Secretary	:	Shri. K. Tiewsoh
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 2,77,860
Business Turnover	:	₹ 83,791
Working Result	:	₹ 42,591

PHLANG MAWSYRPAD FISHERY COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

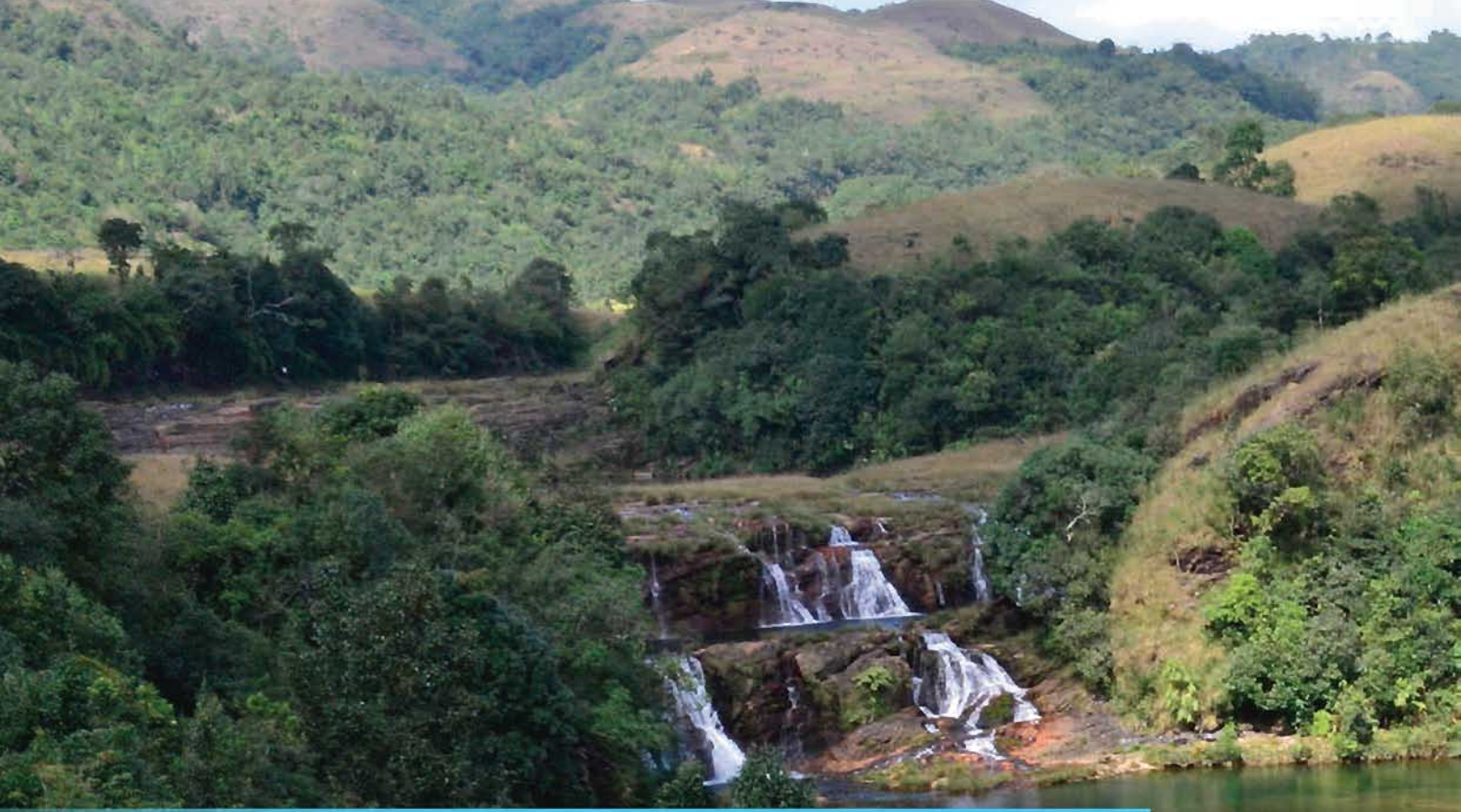
The Phlang Mawsyrpad Fishery Cooperative Society, located 75km from Shillong is the co-operative of the dorbar shnong, a traditional governing institution, of Phlang Mawsyrpad. Their area of operation covers all of Phlang Mawsyrpad, under Mawsynram Development Block, East Khasi Hills, and was registered in 1996. The co-operative has 70 men and 17 women members, comprising of one member from almost every household in the village.

The co-operative functions under the discretion of the local durbar, and cannot take any decisions without the consent of the durbar. Managing committee members of the co-operative are also executive members in the local durbar. Their main activity is fishery; the co-operative has its own pond where fish are reared. Fishing competitions are also organised at this pond.

The fish pond was just 25,000 Sq feet when the local durbar first handed it over to the co-operative. With proper planning and financial assistance from government departments, the area has now increased to a one acre. Fingerlings for rearing were provided by the Fishery Department; some local species that members bring from the rivers nearby, and others purchased from fish traders within and outside the state are also reared. The pond currently yields an annual production of approximately 300kgs of fish on average.

Fishery has helped members and the community to earn additional income from the sale of fish and the fishing competitions. The grounds surrounding the pond also serve as a recreation area for the people of Phlang Mawsyrpad, where various programmes like community picnics, get togethers and festivities are organized.

The co-operative has three regular employees. More workers are employed when the need arises. The fish pond and surrounding land was contributed by the Dorbar Shnong of Janiaw, Lulong and Phlang Mawsyrpad to the co-operative.



MAWPHANLUR INTEGRATED MULTIPURPOSE COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

Mawphanlur Intergrated Multipurpose Co-operative Society located at Markasa, West Khasi Hills was registered in 1998 with the aim of improving the lives of agricultural and livestock farmers of the village.

The co-operative's main business is fishery, poultry and piggery, with a recent diversification into bee keeping. The co-operative began its fishery initiative through its Share Capital, along with supplementary assistance from the Soil Conservation Department. In 2004, with assistance from ICDP, fishery was further developed, and piggery was started. One more fish pond was constructed with the piggery on the pond's bank. Through programmes and trainings from various government institutions, the co-operative recently decided to diversify into goat farming and bee-keeping.

At present, it has four fish ponds; another big pond is to be constructed in the near future which will be funded by a three tier investment model. Sixty percent will come from the Government as Share Capital, ten percent from the co-operative, and thirty percent through a loan.

To achieve a higher level of people's participation, the co-operative with the traditional administration of the village hold regular awareness meeting where they stress upon the importance of co-operative movement and its contribution for their socio-economic well-being.

The co-operative currently comprises of twelve women and eight men. At every event, the co-operative highlights the economic possibilities of their area to members and villagers, reminding them of its vast potential. The multi-farming initiative and improved fishery has notched up the co-operative's annual turn-over.

PROFILE

Name	:	Mawphanlur Integrated Multipurpose Cooperative Society Ltd. Mawphanlur, West Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1998
Membership	:	Male 08 Female 12 Total 20
Chairman	:	Smt. D. L. Lyngkhoi
Secretary	:	Shri. T. Syiemlieh
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 5,36,000
Business Turnover	:	₹ 74,856
Working Result	:	₹ 6,122

Livestock
COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES

LUMNONGRIM LIVESTOCK AND ALLIED FARMING COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

Lumnongrim Livestock and Allied Farming Cooperative Society, is located at Lumnongrim, a village bordering Assam in Byrnihat. A majority of the members are farmers and their main occupation is Agriculture. In order to improve their livelihood, the members co-operatively took up a Piggery with a capacity of 5 boars and 8 sows, and put their best efforts in breeding them. During the year 2011-12 they sold more than 35 piglets. Apart from Piggery, the members have been striving to construct two fish ponds; fingerlings have been purchased and work is underway. Recently, due to the construction work by the National Highway Association of India, one fish pond was covered with sand and mud, rendering the pond in need of immediate repair.

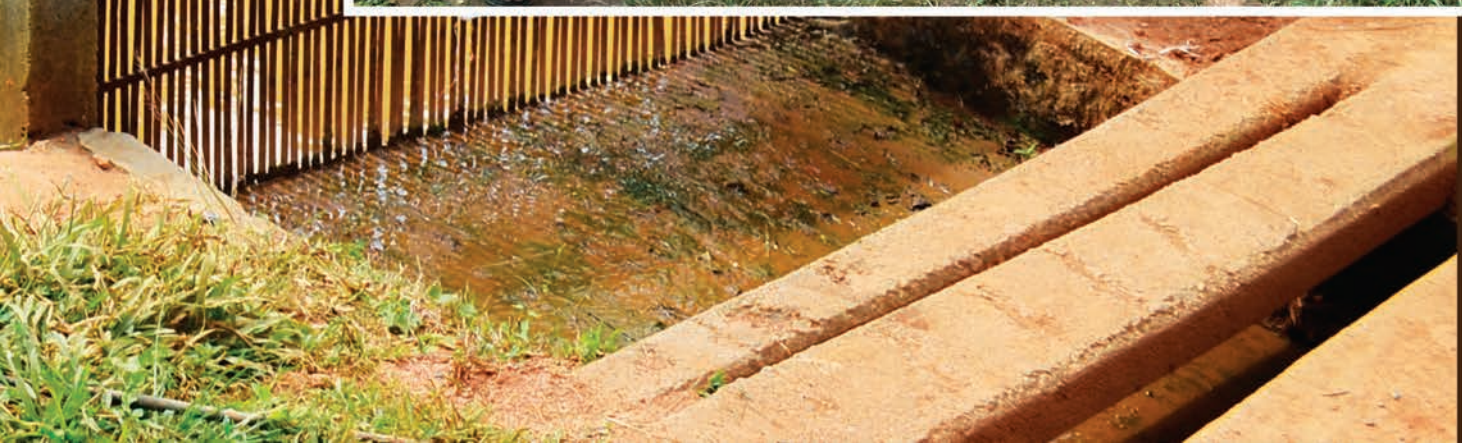
The strength of the cooperative has increased steadily, from ten members in the beginning to twenty two in March 2012, with 14 of the members being women. Although membership in the cooperative is low, it is commendable that they have attempted to acquire two more plots of irrigated land near the co-operative's headquarters to further enhance the fishery business.

Two years after registration, the co-operative implemented few significant changes in its functioning; more specifically by the women members who ventured, in solidarity, to ensure that activities and projects taken up are jointly implemented. Every month, members contribute an amount of one hundred rupees as a supplement for incidental expenses and charges in the cooperative; these new initiatives have actually increased confidence amongst the members.

The co-operative was started in 1994, and registered in 1998 with its area of operation covering all of Lumnongrim, ten kilometres from the Guwahati – Shillong highway. The business activities of the co-operative have considerably enhanced the livelihood of its primarily agrarian members.

PROFILE

Name	:	Lumnongrim Livestock & Allied Farming Cooperative Society Ltd., Byrnihat, Ri Bhoi
Year of Formation	:	1998
Membership	:	Male 8 Female 14 Total 22
Chairman	:	Shri. J. Sema
Secretary	:	Shri. M. Syiem
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 5,44,300
Business Turnover	:	₹ 2,96,777
Working Result	:	₹ 3,095



SYLLEI POULTRY AND PIGGERY COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Syllei Poultry Cooperative Society at Nongkseh under Mylliem Development Block is located about three kilometres from Shillong. Its area of operation covers all of Nongkseh. Nongkseh is a rural area and about half the village depends on agriculture. Piggery and poultry sectors contribute substantially to rural employment. Kong Mora Thangkhiew, the Chairperson of the co-operative took the initiative to register the co-operative to generate additional income and create employment for local youth in the area. Their main objective of the society is to promote and develop economic, social and cultural interests of members, through income generation, supply of farm based goods and services to the area, transport and sale of farm products to the market, access and utilize support services from the government such as the Animal Husbandry and Veterinary Department, and provide loans to members.

During the initial stages from 2003-04 to 2008-09 the co-operative struggled to survive, earn some profit, be self sufficient. With financial assistance from the government, the co-operative took land on lease for their business operations. With their own funds, and interest free loan from members, the co-operative constructed a hygienic sty, a chicken shed and a small store room on the leased land. Now the society has forty piglets, four boars and eight sows. They also have a hundred layers.

They attempted Bokashi piggery in 2008-2009, but the experiment was not very successful with the method unsuited for the place. The co-operative has constructed a two storey shed on another small plot of land. The ground floor serves as a sty, while the first floor is used as the chicken coop. Through these, the co-operative has managed to provide a regular supply of eggs, chicken and piglets to the villagers. The co-operative employs three men and one woman with salary.

PROFILE

Name	:	Syllei Poultry & Piggery Cooperative Society Ltd. Nongkseh, Mylliem Block, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1978
Membership	:	Male 17 Female 12 Total 29
Chairman	:	Smt. M. Thangkhiew
Secretary	:	Shri. K. Thangkhiew
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 1,39,700
Business Turnover	:	₹ 1,16,300
Working Result	:	₹ 19,596

NONGSTOIN POULTRY PRODUCERS COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Nongstoin Poultry Producer Cooperative Society in West Khasi Hills was registered in 1978 by individuals who came together to co-operatively rear and breed poultry as a means of livelihood. For a number of years, the co-operative reared poultry of only local breed, underequipped as they were to handle the more elaborate and scientific methods of rearing the broiler variety of poultry.

In 2001, with training, and increased availability of funds, they felt better equipped to embark on poultry farming with broiler and curoiler birds. The demand for poultry increased, and with it , the volume of business. They also plan to experiment with rearing layers in the near future. In 2004, they received assistance through the Integrated Co-operative Development Project, which encouraged them to train further in poultry farming. This persuaded them to expand fulltime into poultry farming, In 2009, they received assistance from the Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (RKVY), a flagship programme of the Department of Agriculture.

The co-operative is located in Pyndengrei, Nongstoin, with access to the marketplace, where poultry feed and other inputs for business are easily available. This makes their business especially viable. They are the only co-operative in the area to have taken up poultry farming on a significant scale. The co-operative also trains other interested individuals in the skills of poultry farming. Every general meeting includes a session on the current economic viability of the poultry trade. All members receive dividends out of profits earned.

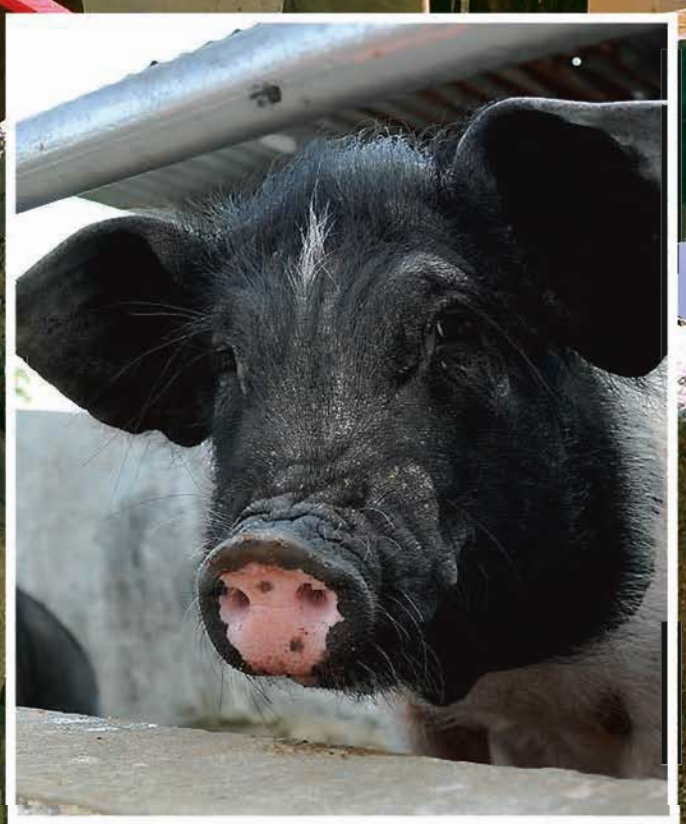
The co-operative owns 1,500 square feet of land, where they go about their poultry farming business. The farm site is motorable, with water source close by. There are currently two women who are full time paid employees of the co-operative. An extension coop is under construction, and on completion, another two trained workers are likely to be employed.

PROFILE

Name	:	Nongstoin Poultry Producers Cooperative Society Ltd. Pyndengrei, Nongstoin, West Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1978
Membership	:	Male 23 Female 25 Total 48
Chairman	:	Smt. S. Syiem
Secretary	:	Smt. G. Iawphniaw
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 1,89,790
Business Turnover	:	₹ 6,24,282
Working Result	:	₹ 14,690

PROFILE

Name	:	Lawsisat Urkasniang Piggery Cooperative Society Ltd. Lawsisat, Nonglang South West Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	2007
Membership	:	Male 21 Female 05 Total 26
Chairman	:	Shri. J. K. Lyngdoh
Secretary	:	Shri. M. Langpen
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 2,06,322
Business Turnover	:	₹ 2,08,700
Working Result	:	₹ 9,855



LAWSISAT URKASNIANG PIGGERY COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Lawsisat Urkasniang Piggery Cooperative Society at Lawsisat, Nonglang Village, Mawkyrwat first organised as a Self Help Group. They registered as a co-operative society in 2007 with the intention of improving the lives of those in their larger community. As a self-help group, they started with just a few pigs, and with a bit of hard work, they were already doing quite well when they registered as a co-operative. The pigs are reared for the purpose of fattening, breeding, and sale. They have eight sties with two to three pigs each, including piglets. The pigs are reared and fattened for about six months before they can be sold. The co-operative runs a successful business selling the pigs not just in the village, but also supplying them to other parts of Mawkyrwat, as well as to surrounding areas outside of Mawkyrwat. Pigs bred by the co-operative are in demand as they are locally bred in hygienic conditions.

Books and Records are always well maintained and kept up-to-date. Besides a Cashbook, the co-operative also maintains a Sales and Purchase Register, Share Scripts/Certificates, Salary, Wages, Registers, and even a Visitors Register. These books are always kept up-to-date. They have one paid employee. The co-operative is also in touch with the Veterinary Department for medicines and vaccines for the pigs. Medicines and vaccines are regularly given to keep the pigs healthy.

The co-operative has its own land and the Piggery Unit has been constructed on this plot. They also have their own tube-well to cater to the water requirements in the piggery. The co-operative has trained personnel in pig farming and almost all members and farmers have at least a rudimentary knowledge of piggery. Besides improved fodder, they also use local fodder like sweet-potatoes, maize and a variety of other vegetables as feed.

Dairy
COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES

PROFILE

Name	:	Umlyngka Primary Milk Producers' Cooperative Society Ltd. Umlyngka, 3rd Mile, Upper Shillong, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1990
Membership	:	Male 64 Female 04 Total 68
Chairman	:	Shri. P.R. Iangjuh
Secretary	:	Shri. P. R. Kharbteng
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 12,56,500
Business Turnover	:	₹ 1,64,20,750
Working Result	:	(-) ₹ 2,72,884

UMLYNGKA PRIMARY MILK PRODUCERS' COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Umlyngka Primary Milk Producers' Cooperative Society, situated about three kilometres away from Shillong was registered in the year 1990. The co-operative started with only two or three dairy farmers from Umlyngka village, Upper Shillong, in 1989. Then the production of milk was only twenty litres a day. These dairy farmers started the co-operative with the aim to encourage dairy farming in the village and to improve the livelihood of the villagers. The co-operative purchases milk from farmers and sells it to the government chilling plant through the veterinary department. The co-operative also offers loans and advances to its members for feed, medicines, calves and other necessaries related to dairy farming.

From the year 2003 to 2006, because of an internal gap, the veterinary department was unable to clear the co-operative's bills. The co-operative had to find a market for the milk elsewhere. The then co-operative secretary, P.R. Kharbteng worked hard to keep members together by getting them financial assistance from different sources in order to support their business. In the year 2006, the veterinary department cleared all it dues to the co-operative, the co-operative paid off all the loans, and also paid the members their dues. Since then the co-operative has functioned smoothly and its business has been growing. The individual farmer brings the milk produced at his farm to the co-operative which ensures marketing and sale of the milk. The vehicle from the veterinary department comes to the village every morning to collect the milk from the co-operative at one collection point, saving them transport and time.

The production of milk has increased from 20 litres a day to 2000 litres a day, and the number of members has increased to 68, with all members actively contributing to the milk sold daily.

MAWKLOT PRIMARY MILK PRODUCERS' COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Mawklot Primary Milk Producers' Co-operative Society was started in 1995, with the intention to better the lives of dairy farmers in the village. It started on a small scale, with few members. It acts as a procurement and marketing agency for the dairy farmers of Mawklot, the co-operative's area of operation. The co-operative purchases the milk from members and sells to the Veterinary Department; for this the co-operative charges a small commission. The farmer does not have to look for ways to market the milk produced at his farm, he only has to bring it to the cooperative and the secretary ensures sale of the milk brought in by its members. The co-operative sells the milk to the Government Chilling Plant through the Veterinary Department. The vehicle from the Veterinary Department comes to the village every morning to collect milk from the members at different collection points. This helps farmers save on transport and time.

The co-operative also gives advances and loans to its members for purchase of feed, medicines, and cattle. As members of the co-operative, individual dairy farmers can also avail various schemes and grants from government departments to expand their business. With approximately 1700 Litres of milk supplied per day to the Veterinary Department, the co-operative is one of the leading milk producers in Shillong.

PROFILE

Name	:	Mawklot Primary Milk Producers' Cooperative Society Ltd. Mawklot, Upper Shillong, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1995
Membership	:	Male 24 Female 0 Total 24
Chairman	:	Shri. D. Rapsang
Secretary	:	Shri. H. Dkhar
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 4,85,600
Business Turnover	:	₹ 1,17,31,267
Working Result	:	(-) ₹ 2,827

PROFILE

Name	:	Kyrwen Primary Milk Producers' Cooperative Society Ltd. Kyrwen, Mookaiaw, West Jaintia Hills
Year of Formation	:	2006
Membership	:	Male 07 Female 08 Total 15
Chairman	:	Shri. A. Lapasam
Secretary	:	Smt. D. Lyngdoh
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 2,92,500
Business Turnover	:	₹ 16,20,892
Working Result	:	₹ 2,00,293

KYRWEN PRIMARY MILK PRODUCERS' COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Kyrwen Primary Milk Producers' Cooperative Society is a group of farmers who organised themselves into a co-operative to collaboratively raise the socio-economic status of its members. The co-operative is located at Kyrwen village, 50 kms from Jowai, under the Dolloiship of Elaka Raliang of West Jaintia Hills District; it consists of seven men and eight women members. The village is well connected by road, and transport plies regularly.

Bah A. Lapasam, the co-operative's Chairperson ushered in the vision of a co-operative when he began a dairy farm at Jowai, where he found little support. Moving to Kyrwen, his ancestral village, he rallied the other farmers, steering their vision towards co-operative efforts in dairy farming. The initial years were trying, but in 2006, the Kyrwen Primary Milk Producers' cum Agro Livestock Cooperative Society was formed and registered. The co-operative rears milch cows, and grows fodder and other cereals for better livestock feed. They began with five milch cows and a temporary loan. With financial assistance from the State Government, the co-operative bought more milch cows and constructed a larger cowshed. Through the RKVY Scheme from the Central Government, they further expanded their business. They now have thirty six milch cows that produce 200 to 300 litres of milk a day. This milk is supplied to the Dairy Plant at Jowai, as well as to the local consumers. The co-operative has also served the purpose of the Veterinary Department; they are the largest supplier of milk to the Chilling Plant at Jowai.

They have seven paid employees who are either skilled or unskilled farmers. The co-operative's welfare practices include lending support to member farmers in cash and in kind, especially in the event of sickness or misfortune. At any death, ₹ 5000/- is given to the bereaved family as support by the cooperative.

SYNTUNG
TATA
ML 05 F 3803

Transport
COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES

PROFILE

Name	:	Nokrek Midan Transport Cooperative Society Ltd. Tura, West Garo Hills
Year of Formation	:	1998
Membership	:	Male 38 Female 08 Total 46
Chairman	:	Smt. G. F. K. Marak
Secretary	:	Shri. P. Moirangthem
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 9,87,000
Business Turnover	:	₹ 4,33,036
Working Result	:	(-) ₹ 21,732

NOKREK MIDAN TRANSPORT COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

Nokrek Midan Transport Cooperative Society was initially started in 1991 by twenty one members working in different fields of life, to develop the transport and communication system in Tura town, and in the Garo Hills Districts of Meghalaya.

With the goal to establish an inter district, as well as intra-district network of transport facilities for the people, their strategy was to operate transport vehicles. Every member contributed a subscription share contribution of ₹ 250.00 per month and within three years the Society could raise up to ₹ 2.56 lakhs. The co-operative launched its first transport business by purchasing one city bus through a loan financed by SBI, Chandmari branch. On clearing the loan, another bus was purchased in 2003.

Nokrek Midan Transport Cooperative Society is the only co-operative operating public transport and rendering a very useful service to the people of Tura. The co-operative inducted twenty five new members, who are all professionals in the field of transport, whether as bus drivers, auto mechanics or conductors.

Recently, they have started operating fifteen Maxi cabs in the urban municipal areas of Tura, in collaboration with the Tura Municipal Board on a 50:50 profit sharing basis. The transport covers nine areas of Tura town. One maxi cab can accommodate upto seven passengers. An approximate daily return ₹ 1000/- per vehicle is earned, amounting to a gross total of ₹ 15000/- per day for all 15 vehicles. As the Tata Maxi cab is in high demand as public transport, the co-operative still needs another twenty cabs to cover areas yet unreached. The Nokrek Midan city bus was also repaired and given a total overhaul. It is back on the road again.

Their future plans include opening petrol pumps, driving schools, a garage, and a vehicle parts and accessories enterprise; and of course to provide transportation facilities to all of Garo Hills.

PROFILE

Name	:	Sein Behiaw Transport Cooperative Society Ltd. Jowai, West Jaintia Hills
Year of Formation	:	1981
Membership	:	Male 42 Female 71 Total 113
Chairman	:	Shri. W. Challam
Secretary	:	Shri. W. Lakiang
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 9,63,600
Business Turnover	:	₹ 46,62,416
Working Result	:	₹ 30,404

SEIN BEHIAW TRANSPORT COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

Faced with varied problems of transport and sale of wares because of the high fares charged to ferry them from and to the market by irregular private bus services, petty businessmen and women in Jowai met together in March 1980. They pooled in ideas and resources to address their continual transport problem by forming a transport co-operative under the name 'Sein Behiaw Transport Cooperative Society'. Through generous contributions from determined members, they were able to raise ₹ 1,35,000/- at the meeting itself; they then purchased a pre-owned bus from Shillong with some additional amount, as suggested by a member who wanted to put the whole idea into action as soon as possible, starting the first transport co-operative society in the state.

The initial years were difficult with stiff competition from existing private bus services and their owners, who influenced a number of members enough to back out of the co-operative. However the remaining members were committed, and within 3 years time they purchased three more buses. With the co-operative formed, the transport needs of the members were met, and market days were no longer difficult. Their services have proven a boon to the marketing community of Jowai, and the general public as well, who now have more regular transport facilities to get to and from the markets and other places.

In normal circumstances, the usual fare is realized but on the market days that are slower, with low transaction and bad weather, the co-operative does not take any fare from members. In the event of death of any family member, ₹ 5,000 is given as support. With sickness or hospitalization of employees, the co-operative usually assists by paying half the bill. In cases of prolonged illness, the co-operative continues their salary to unburden the family. They have twenty-five employees; seven drivers, twelve helpers, and six managers who double as conductors.

SYNTUNG INTEGRATED VILLAGE COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Syntung Integrated Village Cooperative Society is based in Syntung under Mawkynrew Development Block, 70 km from Shillong. Being an Integrated Village Cooperative Society (IVCS), at least one person from every household is a member.

People of Syntung were challenged with transporting their horticultural produce like banana, jackfruit, oranges, black pepper, and forest produce like broomstick to the market. In 2005, they created a fund pool from people in the village, which became their share-capital contribution; they purchased a bazar-bus, partly supported by Meghalaya Cooperative Apex Bank, Smit Branch, through its vehicle loan. Border-Area Syntung Transport Cooperative Society was then registered.

The bus started plying daily between Syntung and Shillong with good turnover, enabling the co-operative to clear the loan in two years. This business necessitated the construction of a godown for farmers' produce. Through the ICDP Scheme in 2008-09, they built an RCC godown. The scheme's entire loan component was cleared in six months.

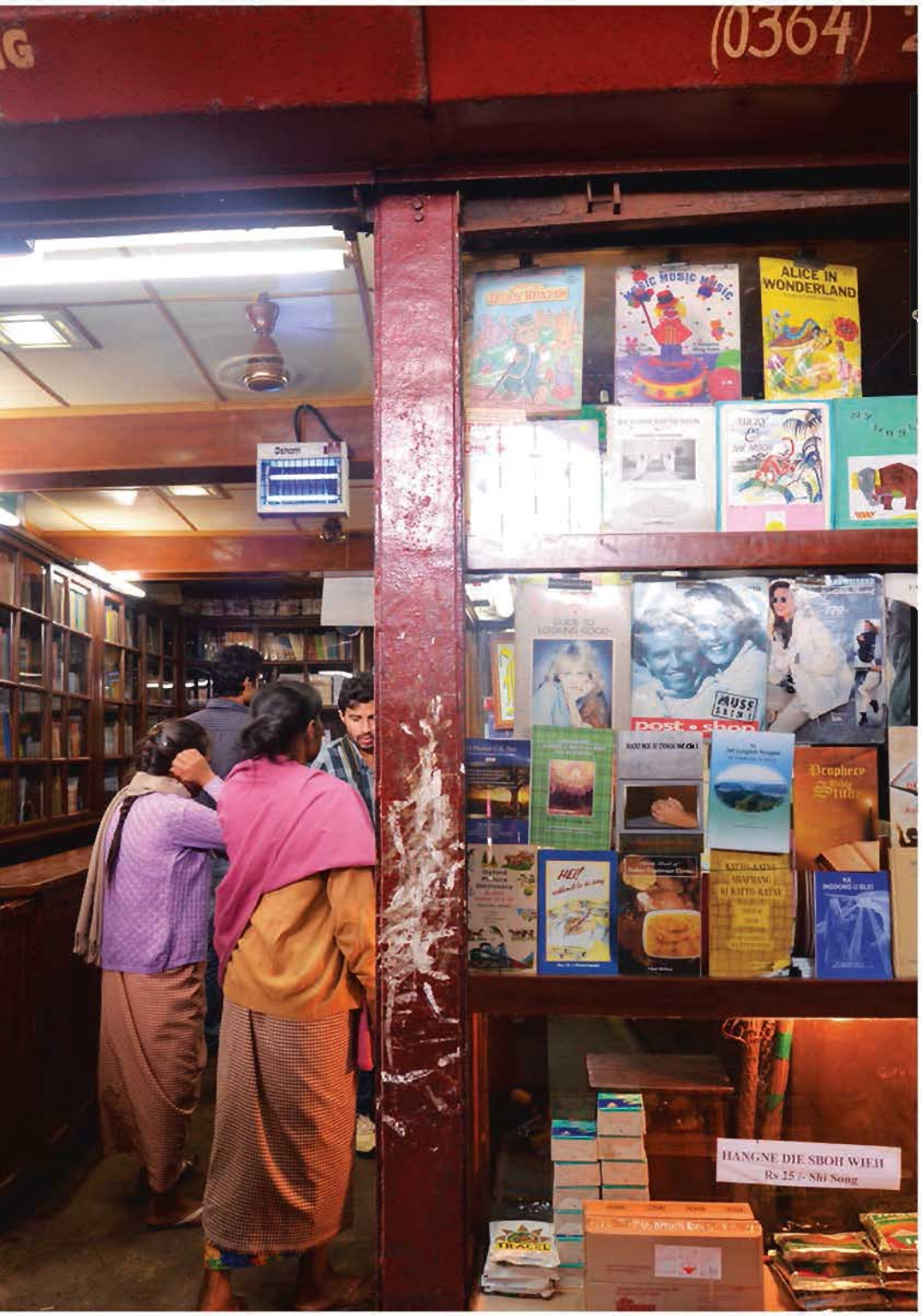
To diversify their business, the Syntung Multipurpose Cooperative Society was registered in 2009. This co-operative received immediate financial support from its parent co-operative and bought a Sumo Maxi Cab, which carries passengers daily between Syntung and Shillong, and patients from the village to hospitals on any emergency call. They own two fish ponds. There is enough land to enlarge the ponds to expand their fishery business. They also opened a Consumer Store in 2011. In the same year, they implemented TERI's Lighting a Billion Lives project. Five solar panels, one solar charging station, along with a mobile charging unit were installed and solar lanterns distributed to members. The co-operative provides charging facilities at ₹ 5.

The two co-operatives were merged in May 2012, amending the name to Syntung Integrated Village Cooperative Society. They have ten full time and five part-time employees with regular monthly salary.

PROFILE

Name	:	Syntung Integrated Village Cooperative Society Ltd. Syntung, Mawkynrew Block, East Khasi Hills
		(Formerly known as Border Area Syntung Transport Cooperative Society Ltd.)
Year of Formation	:	2005
Membership	:	Male 200 Female 100 Total 300
Chairman	:	Shri. A. Dkhar
Secretary	:	Shri. P. Suting
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 15,00,000
Business Turnover	:	₹ 25,00,000
Working Result	:	₹ 8,00,000

Marketing
COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES



PROFILE

Name	:	Shillong Cooperative Marketing Society Ltd., Iewduh, Shillong, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1957
Membership	:	Male 29 Female 30 Total 59
Chairman	:	Shri. M.M. Syiem
Secretary	:	Shri. K.S.R. Jeen
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 1,00,000
Business Turnover	:	₹ 1,06,34,390
Working Result	:	₹ 2,22,071

SHILLONG COOPERATIVE MARKETING SOCIETY LTD.

The Shillong Cooperative Marketing Society at Iewduh, Shillong is one of the oldest cooperatives in the state, registered in 1957 by people who understood the plight of rural farmers at that time. They were committed to address the challenges of the time by touring almost all villages in East Khasi Hills to foster a spirit of cooperation amongst the farmers to work together in the fight against poverty, and to improve the socio-economic conditions of the weaker sections in rural areas. They had a clear vision of the cooperative movement as the ideal way to tackle poverty.

Their area of operation included Smit Village, Nongkrem Village up to Khadarblang of Hima Khyrim, Kyngkhat bordering East Pakistan (now Bangladesh), Balat, Mawpud, Hima Mawsynram, Hima Sohra at that time, and the whole of Shillong.

The co-operative rendered its pioneering service to rural farmers by procuring and facilitating the marketing of horticultural produce like pipul (sohmrit khlaw), bay leaves (latyrpad), as well as honey. Currently, it supplies organic and chemical fertilizers, pesticides, seeds, implements, livestock feed, feed supplements, and veterinary items like animal medicines to rural farmers. Their most ambitious project yet is supplying school and college books at company rates. Besides, the co-operative provides loans to its members for their produce-either raw or processed goods.

The co-operative celebrated its Golden Jubilee on 28th December, 2007. In 1957, the co-operative's office began in an Assam type house that was gutted down by fire in 1958. In 1959, a two storied building was constructed, with the ground floor utilized as godown for storage facilities. In 1961, the government issued a loan to the co-operative for repair and renovation of the existing building. This was completed in 1963. In 1979, another floor was constructed as a top floor, which is still utilized for its business today.

AMLAREM DAWKI SUB-AREA MARKETING COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

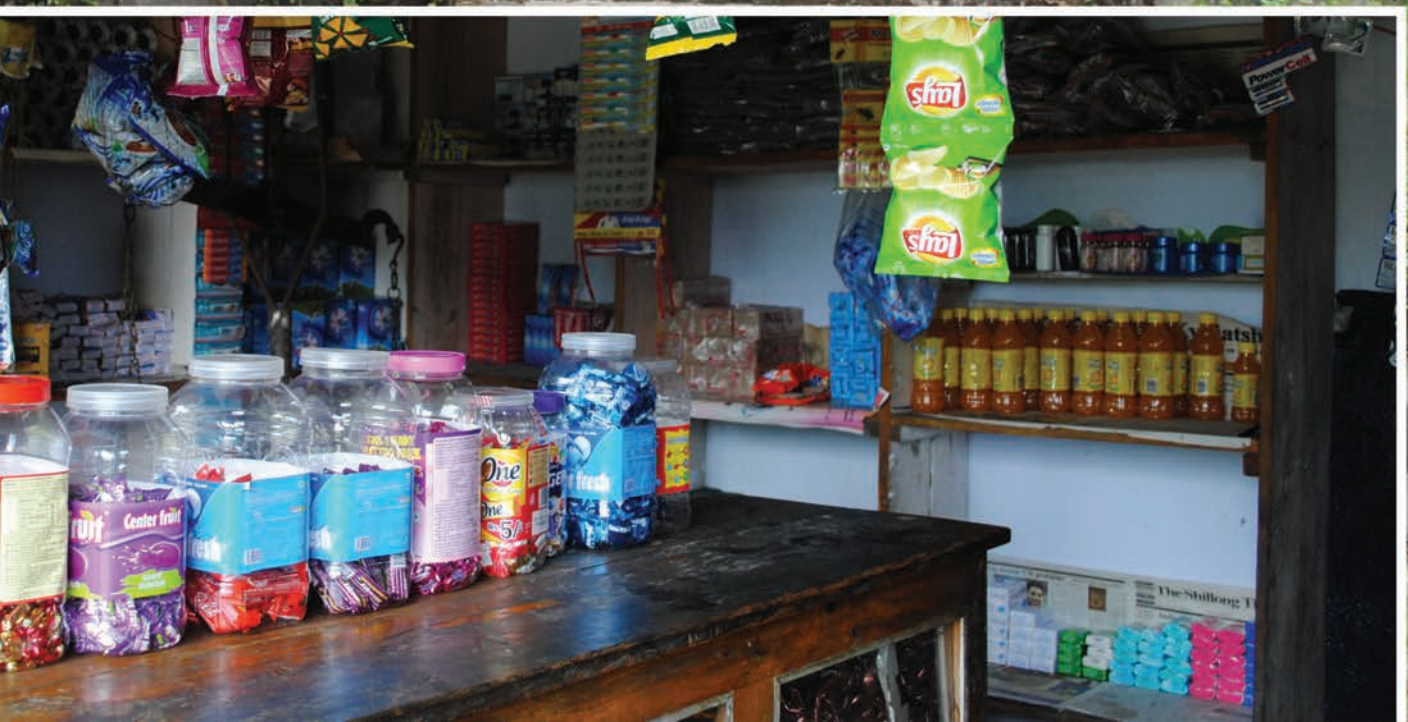
The Amlarem-Dawki Sub-area Cooperative Marketing Society, registered in 1969 is situated at Amlarem in Jaintia Hills District. The co-operative did remarkably well in the first ten years, garnering a substantial profit from wholesale business in rice, broomstick, areca nut processing, and exporting oranges to Bangladesh. This co-operative has seen its share of losses and bad times. For a period after the first ten years, there was a lull, and even a slide in business performance. This changed in 2004, with the construction of a retail outlet and showroom for their 'consumer business'. By 2009, business had picked up, with all loans outstanding and current, from banks and through ICDP, cleared. Products and services were expanded to include black pepper and PDS services leading to the society earning a fair profit. They also supply stationery articles to government offices, and help transport rice to the nearest schools under the Midday Meal Scheme.

In 2010, the co-operative collectively constructed a new building on its land, presently rented by the Office of the Sub-Registrar of Cooperative Societies, Amlarem. It is well fenced with concrete and steel reinforcement, and there are separate living quarters for the chowkidar, toilets, a parking lot, and a fair price shop. In 2011, construction of the first floor began, but had to be discontinued as funds ran low. To address that, all rent received was deposited into a bank account with the aim of completing the first floor by 2013, the construction of which has restarted.

The original membership consisted of three service co-operative societies, the Jaintia Border Warmihngi Service Co-operative Society, the Jaintia Border War Sepngi Service Co-operative Society, and the Jaintia War Pdeng Service Co-operative Society. An additional four co-operative societies and four individuals joined recently, bringing the current membership to eleven.

PROFILE

Name	:	Amlarem Dawki Sub-Area Marketing Cooperative Society Ltd., Amlarem
Year of Formation	:	1970
Membership	:	Individual 4 Societies 7 Total 11
Chairman	:	Shri. M. Dhar
Secretary	:	Shri. T. Suchen
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 16,72,400
Business Turnover	:	₹ 18,64,885
Working Result	:	₹ 11,480



PROFILE

Name	:	Pynursla Sub-Area Marketing Cooperative Society Ltd. Pynursla, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1968
Membership	:	Male 24 Female 06 Total 30
Chairman	:	Shri. K. Pyngrope
Secretary	:	Smt. S. Pyngrope
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 21,36,700
Business Turnover	:	₹ 2,78,691
Working Result	:	₹ 15,245

PYNURSLA SUB-AREA MARKETING COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Pynursla Sub-area Marketing Co-operative Society was formed by the members of six service cooperative societies with five members from each co-operative, who organised themselves as a co-operative to come together and help each other as co-operatives. The society was registered in 1968, constituted of twenty four men and six women. The area of operation consisted of all the villages under Pynursla Block. Since formation, the co-operative started its business solely through shares received from members to sell controlled items like kerosene, clothes, rice, flour, and supplying these to the six service co-operative societies. This was their primary business for a long period. With financial assistance from the government and the National Co-operative Development Corporation, the co-operative now markets forest produce like areca nut, bay leaves, broomstick, betel leaves.

The co-operative purchased land at Pynursla market, where it has constructed a number of godowns and shops. This was done with financial assistance in the form of share capital contribution and loan from the National Co-operative Development Corporation through the Integrated Co-operative Development Project scheme. The godowns and shops are rented out, and the loan has been repaid. The co-operative also owns land at Wahumrem donated to them by the Dorbar Raid. Another godown at Wahumrem sponsored by the State Agricultural Marketing Board was handed to them in August 2012.

The co-operative also owns some small shops in the Sub Area Complex at Pynursla market that are let out at reasonable rates. This helps support local people in their business, providing them a place to sell or store wares at low rent. The co-operative has now started constructing the upper storey of the Society cum shopping complex. The co-operative helps in transport and sale of local produce by procuring them and selling them in markets outside Pynursla. Local farmers benefit the most from these services.

ARHAM
ARHAM B.P.T

Consumer
COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES

PROFILE

Name	:	State Bank of India Employees' Consumer Cooperative Store Ltd., Shillong, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1991
Membership	:	Male 166 Female 120 Total 286
Chairman	:	Smti. C. Dympep
Secretary	:	Shri. K. Dutta
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 5,89,200
Business Turnover	:	₹ 50,84,929
Working Result	:	₹ 90,833

STATE BANK OF INDIA EMPLOYEES' CONSUMER COOPERATIVE STORE LTD.

The State Bank of India Employees' Consumer Co-operative Store was established in 1991 with the intention to enable members to buy consumer goods and items at a reasonable rate. As such, the store deals in all kinds of dry goods and grocery, stationery, and other essential items, all sold at a rate below the marked price.

The store was started by the employees of State Bank of India, Shillong branch. Shares were sold at ₹.100 per share, with an upper limit of ten shares per person, as laid down in the co-operative's bye-laws. This served as their Share Capital, and its business of a consumer co-operative store was started, with the newly opened shop located at the premises of State Bank of India's main branch at Shillong. The co-operative store has become a part of daily life for members, and it has spread an awareness of the co-operative movement among the members, their families, and neighbours.

The store remains open up to four hours a day, usually in the afternoons. The shop is open to public as well. Often, customers who are not co-operative members avail of the store's services, benefiting from its low prices. More recently, a car has been purchased to start home-delivery services. The home-delivery service offered is however only open to members, who pay a fixed charge of ₹.10 per delivery trip.

Since inception, records and accounts have been well maintained, even as the business bulk grew and expanded. The co-operative has been given an "A" grade in all the audit reports submitted to the Office of the Registrar of Co-operative Societies. In the past year, business has grown, and the co-operative's membership also increased to 286. Profits are increasing; dividends have been paid to members and to the government as well. The co-operative employs four men with monthly salary at the store.

DEPARTMENTAL CONSUMERS' COOPERATIVE STORE LTD.

Originally registered as the Umpling Consumer Co-operative Store, the Departmental Consumers' Co-operative Store is located at R&R Colony. The area used to be called the Umpling Rehabilitation Colony, allocated by the Central Government to rehabilitate and resettle those displaced from East Pakistan by the Partition of 1947.

When rehabilitation and resettlement began, the area was uninhabited, except for farmers and woodsmen in the neighbouring villages like Umpling and Rynjah. They had no access to electricity, water, roads, markets, transport and communications services to the place or out of it. Essential commodities like rice, sugar, S.K. Oil and others were not easily available. Between 1960 and 1964, with India's wars with Pakistan and China, the distribution of such commodities was controlled by the Government of India through authorized Fair Priced Shops and Co-operative Consumer's Societies against a valid Family Identity Card. Such a system had not been put in place at the Colony.

Senior community members decided to do something for themselves and improve their situation. The Umpling Consumer's Co-operative Stores was registered in 1963. They applied for and received a permit for distributorship of controlled goods, and to distribute these to consumers themselves against their Family Identity Cards. The co-operative was presided over by Amiya Kanti Dutta; Kamini Kumar Dey was Secretary. The co-operative acquired land and constructed a building in 1986, moving out of the space they had rented till then. In 2001, with a loan from the NCDC and assistance through the local Legislator's Area Development Fund, an RCC construction came up in its place.

Today, more than 700 card holders avail of essential commodities from them, as well as other groceries and essentials kept in stock and sold below marked price. The store is open to public as well. The co-operative is staffed by nine paid employees.

PROFILE

Name	:	Departmental Consumers' Cooperative Store Ltd. R&R Colony, Umpling, Shillong, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1963
Membership	:	Male 807 Female 192 Total 999
Chairman	:	Shri. D. Das
Secretary	:	Shri. S. Shyam
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 6,60,940
Business Turnover	:	₹ 78,84,659
Working Result	:	₹ 1,36,506

Processing
COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES

URLONG TEA PROCESSING UNIT OF TEA GROWERS COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Tea Growers Co-operative Society Ltd. at Mawlyngngot village, forty-five kilometers from Shillong, is a co-operative of farmers who got together to collectively improve their lot, and those of other farmers through growing tea. Their cultivation practices have been exclusively organic, with no chemical pesticides or fertilizers ever involved. While this has resulted in lower yields, they have been granted an Organic Certification from the Control Union of Organic Certificates, Maharashtra, India.

The Co-operative has also started a tea processing plant as a pilot project, with a small capacity rolling table, and indigenous equipment like the withering trough and a drying machine. This unit produces black tea, green tea, and white tea under the brand name Urlong Tea. Tea processing is of two types- CTC and Orthodox and Urlong Tea falls under the latter. The Co-operative's dynamic Chairperson, D.L. Nongspung dedicates himself to caring for the business affairs of the Co-operative. The Organic Certification they have received allows them to tap into the international market that is increasingly conscious of this label.

The Urlong Tea Processing Unit of the Tea Growers Co-operative Society Ltd., is a commercial initiative, with a focus on the economic sustainability of tea growing in the area. Tea farmers own and run their individual gardens, with an implied agreement of interdependence: that they would sell the leaves plucked from these gardens to the Co-operative owned processing plant. This tea processing unit is currently the only asset that operates for the collective benefit of all the farmers in the area.

PROFILE

Name	:	Urlong Tea Processing Unit of Tea Growers Cooperative Society Ltd. Mawlyngot, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	2011
No. of Members	:	Male 10 Female 11 Total 21
Chairman	:	Shri. D. L. Nongspung
Secretary	:	Shri. R. Nongspung
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 7,34,674
Business Turnover	:	₹ 4,39,224
Working Result	:	₹ 98,290

PROFILE

Name	:	Garo Hills Cooperative Cotton Ginning Mills & Oil Mills Ltd., Phulbari, West Garo Hills
Year of Formation	:	1954
Membership	:	PACS 17 · Marketing Societies 10 · Others 27 · Individuals 127 · Govt. 1 · Total 182
Chairman	:	Deputy Commissioner, West Garo Hills
Secretary	:	Shri. B.P. Modak, Assistant Registrar of Cooperative Societies, Tura
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 2,37,43,305
Business Turnover	:	₹ 1,34,99,487
Working Result	:	₹ 5,14,764

GARO HILLS COOPERATIVE COTTON GINNING MILLS AND OIL MILLS LTD.

The Garo Hills Cooperative Ginning Mills and Oil Mills, at Phulbari, was established on 30.11.1954; its area of operation at the time included the composite districts of East, West and South Garo Hills. It started with 182 members. In order to tap the available cotton and mustard locally grown in the district, and to augment the livelihoods of local farmers, the mill was set up. The initiative also effectively reduced the prevailing exploitative practices of Middle Men.

However, over a span of 50 years, the Mill gradually lost out to competition from newly established private ginning units in the area. The cooperative went through a slump, but things changed in 1996 with a decision to diversity. Realising its potential, the North Eastern Regional Agricultural Marketing Corporation (NERAMAC) revived the Society, collaborating with it in a cashew processing project. Initially, the mill procured and processed 1350 quintals of cashew. Subsequently, in 2003-04 a Memorandum of Understanding was signed with a private party from Dhubri on a 60:40 profit share basis, further expanding its activities by procuring and processing approximately 6000 quintals of raw cashew; this was followed with arrangements to market the finished product from the mill itself.

With the rise in cashew production, the mill has taken advantage of the demand for raw cashew, being exported to other parts of the country to be processed. The mill started massive processing of raw cashew, currently engaging at least 100 local labourers for the processing, which also provides livelihood opportunities for them. With the diversification into procurement, processing and marketing of cashew, the mill now capably competes with other private industries in the surrounding areas, providing employment to locals through its drying, segregating, peeling, conditioning and roasting processes. The 6J cashew nut variety is in high demand and known for its superior quality.

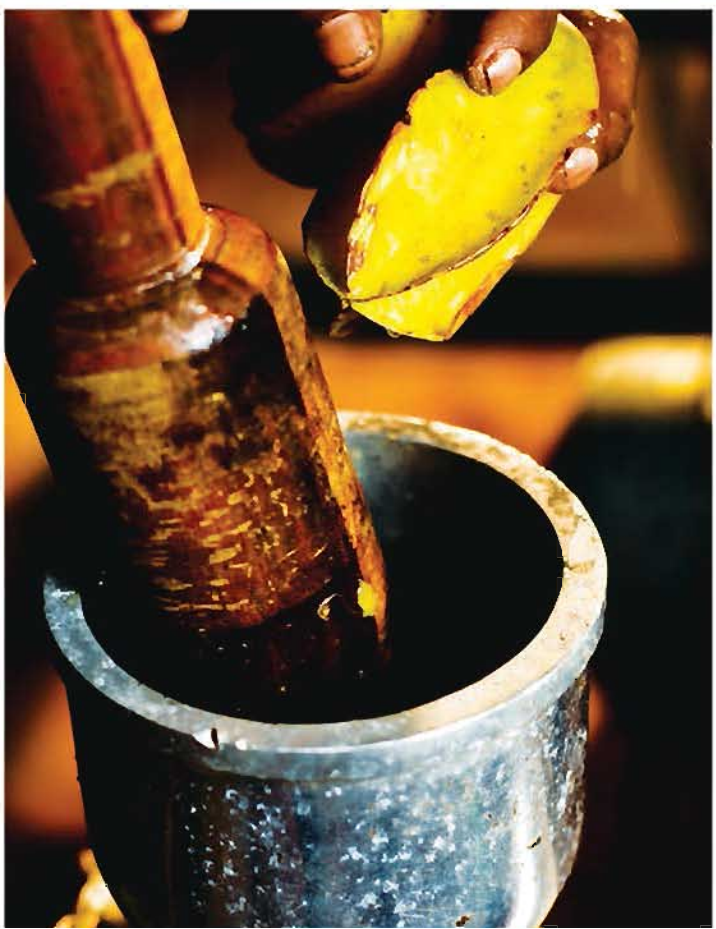
PASHUM WAHKDAIT ROPEWAY TRANSPORT, FRUIT AND VEGETABLE PROCESSING UNIT AND LIVESTOCK COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Pashum Wahkdait Ropeway Transport Fruit and Vegetable Processing Unit and Livestock Cooperative Society was formed by fifteen people residing in and around the Wahkdait and Pashum area in East Khasi Hills, to address the surface transport problems of communities living in these two remote places, especially Pashum. The co-operative was registered in 1999, with its area of operation as Pashum and Wahkdait with the objective of developing means to transport goods and commodities across the two villages.

The ropeway is located at Wahkdait and connected to the remote village of Pashum. It is the only way to bring in essential goods and commodities from Wahkdait to Pashum. It also serves to transport agricultural and forest produce for sale from Pashum to Wahkdait, the nearest station for them. With an abundance of horticultural produce to be found in the area, the co-operative later expanded their operations to fruit processing. They produce quality pineapple squash and other fruit juices. In more recent years, they extended their activities to livestock like poultry, piggery, and fishery. The co-operative's products are much in demand in the area, and plans to export these to Bangladesh are in the pipeline.

At inception, the co-operative started its business activities by share contribution from members. Later, the co-operative received financial assistance from the government through the Border Areas Department dealing with ropeway transport. Under the Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana scheme, they received funds for their livestock and fruit produce trade. The co-operative owns two acres of land, registered under its name.

The co-operative transports and markets produce from members and non-members alike, supplying these to different markets in the vicinity and beyond. The ropeway has served as a lifeline in many ways, especially for the people of Pashum, providing access to goods and services otherwise almost inaccessible to them.



PROFILE

Name	:	Pashum Wahkdait Ropeway Transport, Fruit & Vegetable Processing Unit & Livestock Cooperative Society Ltd., Wahkdait, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1999
Membership	:	Male 10 Female 10 Total 20
Chairman	:	Shri. K. Tangsang
Secretary	:	Shri. N. Suting
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 22,79,600
Business Turnover	:	₹ 13,01,023
Working Result	:	₹ 3,08,988

PROFILE

Name	:	Rud Kupli Mynksar Service Cooperative Society Ltd., looksi, West Jaintia Hills
Year of Formation	:	1967
Membership	:	Male 80 Female 40 Total 120
Chairman	:	Shri. J. Lyngdoh
Secretary	:	Shri. B. Tang
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 7,58,530
Business Turnover	:	₹ 10,02,572
Working Result	:	(-) ₹ 1,41,087

RUD KUPLI MYNKSAR SERVICE COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

Rud Kupli Mynksar Service Cooperative Society located at Iooksi, about 60 kms from Jowai, and is under the Dolloiship of Raliang Elaka in West Jaintia Hills began in 1967 with sixty three members. It operates in Iooksi, Nongkynrih, Iawthymme, Saphai, Umsalait, Iongsaro, Thang Thning, Khonshnong, Madan Pohkseh, Rud Kupli, Priang, and Iong u lang.

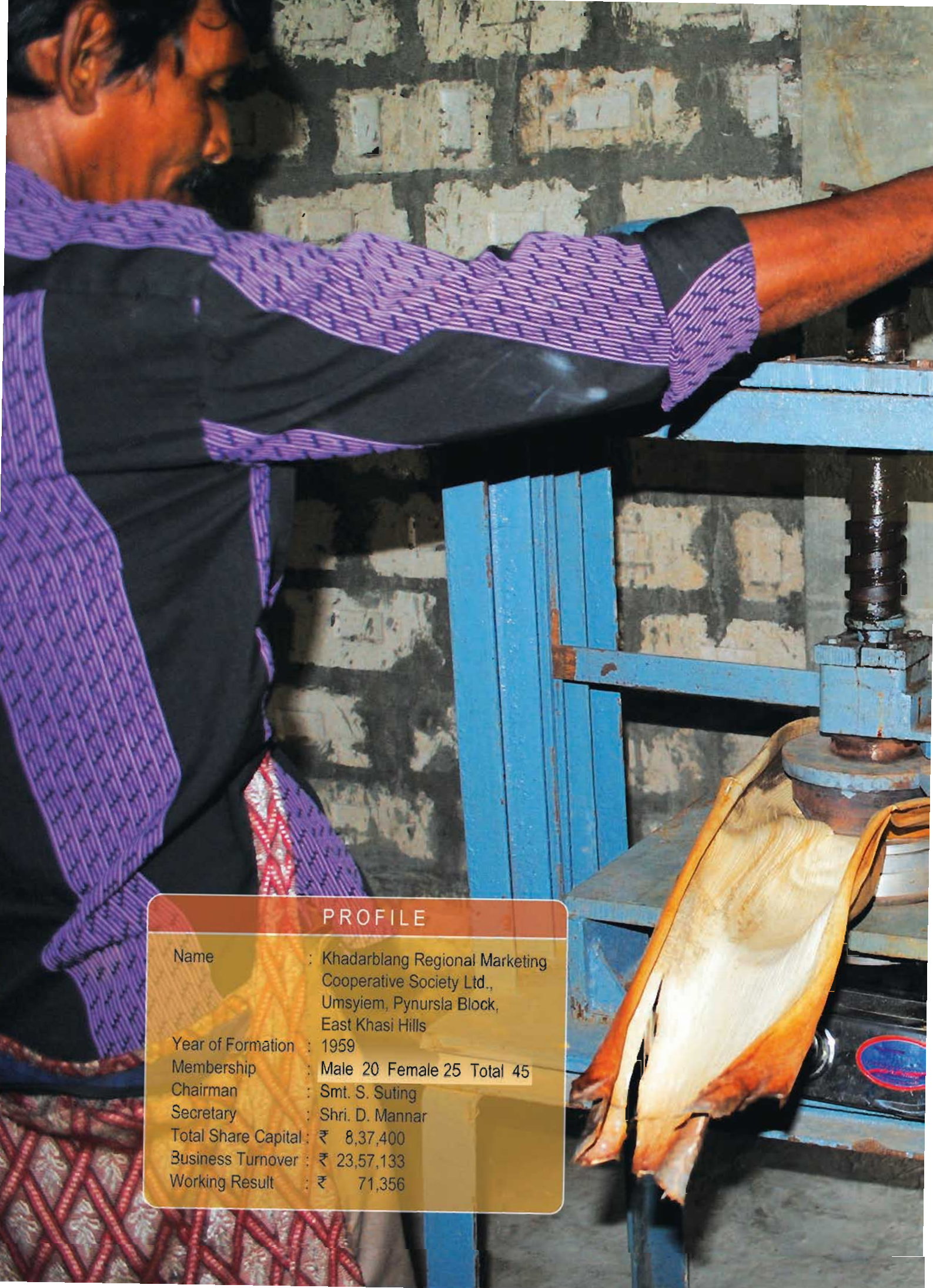
The co-operative became non-functional for a brief period, before it was revived in 2004 through the Integrated Cooperative Development Project Scheme. With it, the co-operative's membership has grown to one hundred and twenty, of which forty are women. Their main activity is the cultivation of turmeric and ginger. They also plant broomsticks.

Apart from this, they run a consumer shop. Alongside, they deal in the supply and sales of rice, areca nut, charcoal, hardware, consumer items, NC cloth, shoes, schoolbooks, and stationery. The co-operative has also started a Deposit Mobilisation Centre through which they encourage thrift savings among the community in their area of operation. Two sales assistants have been engaged with a salary.

The co-operative owns some land where a godown and a work shed have been built. Planning to diversify its business, the process of starting a Turmeric Processing Plant is underway. With a loan under the PMEGP Scheme, a processing unit is being set up at its godown at Saphai. The basic machinery has been procured. Their work shed has also been recently renovated and a well has been dug.

With the new processing plant, the co-operative would increase its business, while supporting the community by procuring their turmeric and ginger produce. The produce shall be acquired from members and non-members alike, and processed at the plant, creating a healthy system of inter-dependence and self-sufficiency in the community. The plant should be fully functional by March 2013.

Industrial
COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES



PROFILE

Name	:	Khadarblang Regional Marketing Cooperative Society Ltd., Umsyiem, Pynursla Block, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1959
Membership	:	Male 20 Female 25 Total 45
Chairman	:	Smt. S. Suting
Secretary	:	Shri. D. Mannar
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 8,37,400
Business Turnover	:	₹ 23,57,133
Working Result	:	₹ 71,356

KHADARBLANG REGIONAL MARKETING COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Khadarblang Regional Marketing Co-operative Society at Umsyiem Village in Pynursla Development Block was registered in 1959 with the aim of improving the lot of local farmers by assisting them in reaching their produce to a wider market. Initially, it began with buying produce from local farmers and transporting them to markets in Shillong and other places. This was a relief for local farmers who had little means to sell their produce anywhere beyond the local market. The produce included orange, pineapple, citrus, jack fruits, broomstick, black pepper and such like. With assistance and free transportation facilities from the Border Areas Department, the co-operative used to market these as far as Guwahati. In later years, as the Border Areas Department imposed fares for transportation of produce, that became less viable. Production of pineapple, jack fruit, orange and other citrus in the area waned post 1985. On top of this, the Border Area Department closed their transportation facilities, and the co-operative's business dipped for a while.

The co-operative owns a godown at Pynursla donated by the then Assam Government. Under the Assam Government, it was used to stock consumer goods, Pynursla being the main 'station' for villages in the area that were unreached by proper transport infrastructure. After the creation of the state of Meghalaya, the Government of Assam handed it over to the co-operative. Recently, with financial assistance from the government, the co-operative procured a machine to make bio-degradable disposable plates from areca nut leaves. This provides employment for locals, as well as livelihood opportunities through the sale of areca nut leaves as raw material for the plates.

The co-operative also constructed another godown on a 3800 sq. ft. plot at Umsyiem Village, directly funded by NCDC and completed through ICDP assistance. It is well located, within easy reach of road transport.

KSHAID BEE KEEPERS INDUSTRIAL COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Kshaid Bee-keepers Industrial Cooperative is located at a cluster called Kshaid, Nongtraw, Khrang, Mawshuid, Wah Sohra and other villages of Kshaid Khatarshnong, forty nine kilometers from Sohra. It was registered in 1987 with the vision of community development and economic upliftment. Members are cultivators and bee keepers by trade. The co-operative gathers raw honey from wild bee colonies, then using traditional knowledge, process and purify the honey for consumption.

The co-operative began with almost no infrastructure and little technical knowledge. Bee-Keeping is done in a forest area where many flowering plants grow naturally; movable wooden frames with boxes are placed at such locations and the bees leave fresh honey sucked from flowers in the cells of honey-combs in the boxes to eat bee feed. When these cells are full of honey, the honey is extracted from these cells, and hermetically sealed by capping with wax. Extraction is done thrice a year. Freshly extracted honey is warm and easy to bottle. Present production is 100-200 Kg annually.

The joint effort of the co-operative and the population at large to keep the forest as isolated as possible for successful bee-keeping also safeguards the environment.

The co-operative's success has encouraged and motivated the villagers to take up bee-keeping for themselves This in turn offers livelihood alternatives to the community members who collect the honey and sell it to the co-operative for purifying and bottling. This interdependence fosters a sense of economic security and growth in the community. The co-operative tries its best to empower women towards economic welfare and upliftment of families, individual members, and the community as a whole.

PROFILE

Name	:	Kshaid Bee Keepers Industrial Cooperative Society Ltd. Kshaid, Khatarshnong, Sohra
Year of Formation	:	1987
Membership	:	Male 13 Female 06 Total 19
Chairman	:	Shri. B. Buhphang
Secretary	:	Smt. J. Buhphang
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 2,50,500
Business Turnover	:	₹ 1,40,800
Working Result	:	₹ 5,078

PROFILE

Name	:	DOFEI Computer Centre & Industrial Cooperative Society Ltd. New Nongstoin, West Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	2005
Membership	:	Male 08 Female 09 Total 17
Chairman	:	Smt. B. J. Syiemlieh
Secretary	:	Shri. F. Thongni
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 4,29,000
Business Turnover	:	₹ 3,59,305
Working Result	:	₹ 60,473

DOFEI COMPUTER CENTRE AND INDUSTRIAL COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The DOFEI Computer Centre and Industrial Cooperative Society at Nongstoin, West Khasi Hills, is one of the few industrial co-operative societies in the state, and focuses on information technology as a tool for the growth and development of its members and the community. The objectives as laid down in their bye-laws cover all aspects of the IT sector, from sales and services to manufacturing.

The co-operative is a pioneer in addressing the gap in computer education and information technology awareness in their community. The co-operative has enrolled over two thousand students its various short and long term computer courses. Computer training and education has been given priority as a skill-building strategy, particularly for the youth, and also to set a base for subsequent business activities. Past pupils have been employed in various government departments and organizations, private organisations, schools, tele-companies, call centres, and others; many have also started their own business ventures like DTP centres, cyber cafés, and the like. With eleven short term programmes, the co-operative has also tied up with Martin Luther Christian University to run some of the University's Diploma and Post Graduate Diploma courses in Computer Applications.

In 2012, the co-operative ventured into computer repair and related services. Statistics show that sale of home-based PCs and laptops in their area of operation has increased significantly, offering fair prospects for progress in this line. Marketing and sales of computer items and related accessories like peripherals, tablets, and mobiles is in the pipeline as a business expansion strategy for the current year; they are optimistic about prospects and intend to roll out this business at the earliest.

Registered in 2005, the co-operative owns 2500 square feet of land at Mawbyrshem, Wahriat Nongstoin, where a single hall RCC structure has been constructed. They have nine salaried employees as staff.

OFFICE
Centre for Computer Education

JAINTIA BORDER WARMIHNGI SERVICE COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Jaintia Border Warmihngi Service Cooperative Society at Muktapur in West Jaintia Hills was formed in 1965 and registered in 1970. The co-operative's main business revolves around processing and sale of areca nut. Till 1985, the co-operative fared well and was in active operation. Post 1985, however, there were signs of decline. Books and records that the co-operative maintained were lost, and for a time, it was almost inactive. In 2003, with the ICDP Share Capital Contribution Scheme introduced, the co-operative was revived, and new office bearers were elected. Between 2003 to 2005, with Share Capital Contribution and a loan from ICDP, a furnished office-cum-godown was constructed on land bought and owned by the co-operative. It was inaugurated in September 2005. From then on, there has been no looking back for this co-operative, as it swung back into business with areca nut processing, which remains its main business today.

In June 2011, the co-operative expanded its business into a Deposit Mobilisation Operation with 86 members depositing an amount of ₹ 7,07,296/-, and ₹ 1,83,481/- withdrawn. In February 2012, a stationery shop was opened, where sales in the first few months of its inaugural year have exceeded one and a half lakh rupees. In June 2012, the Office of the Registrar of Cooperative Societies, Meghalaya, Shillong presented the co-operative with a machine for the production of bio-degradable disposable plates from areca nut leaves.

Between 1972 and 1985, the society had 71 men and 22 women members who were all actively involved in various aspects of the co-operative's functions. That number dwindled in the interim years when the co-operative's activities were in decline. Today, their membership has increased, with a shift in gender balance with 55 men and 208 women members. The co-operative also provides salaried employment to two men and a woman.

PROFILE

Name	:	Jaintia Border Warmihngi Service Cooperative Society Ltd., Muktapur, Amlarem
Year of Formation	:	1970
Membership	:	Male 55 Female 208 Total 263
Chairman	:	Shri. W. Pohphlet
Secretary	:	Shri. M. Manner
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 4,25,860
Business Turnover	:	₹ 1,93,199
Working Result	:	₹ 17,729

PROFILE

Name	:	Umklai Area Integrated Cooperative Society Ltd., Umklai, Nongpoh, Ri Bhoi
Year of Formation	:	1997
Membership	:	Male 25 Female 25 Total 50
Chairman	:	Shri. H. Syngkli
Secretary	:	Shri. K. Pamshong
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 5,59,590
Business Turnover	:	₹ 9,85,628
Working Result	:	(-) ₹ 18,937

UMKLAI AREA INTEGRATED COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Umklai Area Integrated Cooperative Society is located at Umklai, a small quiet hamlet lying off the National Highway 40 at an approximate distance of 15kms from the District Head quarter, Nongpoh in Ri Bhoi District, Meghalaya. Umklai is an agricultural village. The co-operative was registered in 1997, with the aim to co-operatively bring in socio-economic development to the village and its people.

The society procures agricultural produce from farmers and sell these at a small profit margin in the markets. It also undertakes ginger cultivation and runs a nursery where fruit saplings are sold. But much of its business activities are focused on marketing loofah commercially, with some value added. Besides selling them as bath scrub, loofah is used to make slippers, decorative items, such as key chains, flower vases and others. This creates an avenue for alternative livelihoods for villagers and also significantly augments the income, not only of Umklai village, but the surrounding areas as well. Employment is generated for the people who plant the saplings, harvest the gourd, peel it, cut, soak, and dry. The co-operative employs 8 skilled workers for designing loofah product.

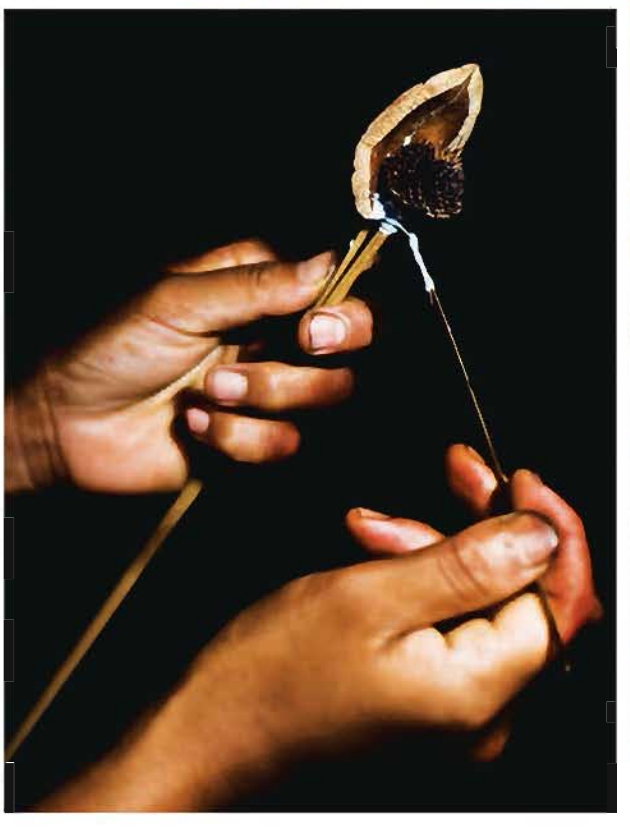
Infrastructure availed by the co-operative through the ICDP scheme includes a workshed with sewing machines, construction of a water tank for soaking, tools and other requirements. With collective consent, the co-operative availed support through the Backward Region Grant Fund (BRGF) for an office cum-industrial unit, the construction of which is almost finished.

A challenge facing the co-operative is the availability of the raw product which is grown abundantly only in and around Umklai village. To this end, many awareness programmes have been conducted, to motivate surrounding villages to grow loofah. The unit could then source the much needed raw material, which in turn would supplement the income of these villages, through a continuous buy-back agreement.

Multipurpose
COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES

PROFILE

Name	:	Women's Group & Handicraft Multipurpose Cooperative Society Ltd. Mowkyndeng, West Jaintia Hills
Year of Formation	:	2002
Membership	:	Male 0 Female 366 Total 366
Chairman	:	Smt. M. Lyngdoh
Secretary	:	Smt. I. Pakma
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 8,92,000
Business Turnover	:	₹ 24,21,357
Working Result	:	₹ 3,06,192



WOMEN'S GROUP AND HANDICRAFT MULTIPURPOSE COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Women's Group and Handicraft Multipurpose Cooperative Society started as a self help group with the purpose of fighting poverty and unemployment, a common enemy in rural Meghalaya. In 1999, the women of Madankynsaw, Mowkyndeng under the leadership of Isabella Pakma formed a self help group called Women's Group Madankynsaw SHG. In 2002, the group registered as a cooperative society under the name The Women Group and Handicraft Multipurpose Cooperative Society, at Mowkyndeng. The co-operative is a group of unemployed rural women who organized themselves to cooperatively improve their economic condition and social status.

The co-operative's objective is to empower women, facilitate their independence and self reliance, generate employment opportunities, promote the indigenous skills in arts and crafts, and preserve their identity.

Their activities include different types of organic vegetable cultivation throughout the year. This produce is then sold locally and at other local markets where they are in demand. The vegetable patches are fertilized with their own vermi-compost, which they also sell. The co-operative supplies this to the Horticulture Department. Trainings in vermi-composting are also organized for the people of neighbouring Raliang, Mulieh, Mulum, Niawkmai, Sahsniang villages by the society.

The co-operative makes cane and bamboo handicraft, woodcraft, and decorative pieces. These are supplied to agents, sold at markets, at exhibitions, and in the co-operative's showroom. They also own a consumer shop where different consumer goods are made accessible to villagers. Apart from these, they also run a beauty salon, where women can be trained in different aspects of this business.

Health camps are organized annually; necessaries like rice, clothing, school books, school uniforms, stationery and others are provided for deprived children and families. Programs on self employment for educated unemployed youth and motivational campaign programs for artisans are regular features.

PROGRESSIVE PRIMARY MULTIPURPOSE COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Progressive Primary Multipurpose Cooperative Society (MUCOOP) was officially registered with the Sub-Registrar of Cooperative Societies, Ri-Bhoi Sub-Division Nongpoh, in January 1992, with the aim of promoting and developing the economic and cultural interests of the area while encouraging thrift, cooperation, self-help and mutual assistance.

Being a Registered Government Supplier, it caters to supply of all kinds of office stationery, Information Technology machines and accessories ranging from Photocopy Machines, Desktop PCs and other related peripherals within the State. The co-operative's electronic segment comprises different national business partners such as HP, Godrej, Boyce, Xerox and others. The co-operative provides after- sale services on IT products, ensuring that clients stay satisfied.

They have further diversified into Poultry farming supplies. The co-operative is the authorized distributor of Amrit Feeds in Meghalaya, aimed to cater the needs of local farmers/growers in the region. The co-operative, through its different outlets provide the sale of day-old chicks, feed, equipment and medicine for commercial broiler chicken farms in Ri Bhoi, East Khasi Hills and Jaintia Hills Districts.

The co-operative has started micro-financing Poultry farmers in Ri-Bhoi District. As part of its endeavour to contribute to the growth of the community, they recently started the Integrated Farming Project to encourage local farmers. The farmers are provided with sufficient supply of feed, vaccines, technical support and an agreement on profit share percentage. To facilitate this, the co-operative has set up offices strategically at Umsning , Nongpoh and Umroi. From these, there are about thirty-five beneficiaries.

Through its Farmer's Development Programme, the co-operative organized a one day training workshop programme at Umsning by involving officers and experts of different Line-Departments. In addition, the co-operative has also organized a health camp at Khlieh Umtrew. The co-operative is also the authorised dealer for fresh chilled chicken items from Amrit Hatcheries' brand of Fresco Pollo.

PROFILE

Name	:	Progressive Primary Multipurpose Cooperative Society Ltd. Byrnihat, Ri Bhoi
Year of Formation	:	1992
Membership	:	Male 24 Female 09 Total 33
Chairman	:	Smt. L.M. Syiem
Secretary	:	Smt. D. Singh
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 27,47,500
Business Turnover	:	₹ 6,82,06,415
Working Result	:	₹ 22,45,750

UMNGOT MULTIPURPOSE COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

Umngot Multipurpose Cooperative Society located at Siangkhnai Village, 72 km from Shillong under Mawkynrew Development Block was registered in 2009.

Farmers of Siangkhnai mainly plant horticultural crops like betel leaf, black pepper, jack fruit, oranges, other citrus fruits and also broom stick. They also have a keen interest in bee-keeping. Selling their produce in markets outside the village posed a problem. They decided to co-operatively take charge of this gap by registering a co-operative that would buy their produce collectively and take the responsibility to market them safely. With share capital fixed at ₹ 1000 per member, the co-operative began marketing the farmers' horticultural produce.

Siangkhnai Village is ideal for poultry farming, and members have taken it up. The co-operative collects the eggs to market them also. Hens which have stopped laying eggs are sold for meat. The high market demand of the eggs encouraged the members to expand their poultry farms.

An interesting activity is bee-keeping. Siangkhnai is surrounded by a variety of citrus trees which is ideal for bees to produce their honey. The co-operative hygienically bottles the raw honey collected from members. Being pollution-free, bee-keeping in Siangkhnai has great potential for expansion.

A solar charging station for solar lanterns and a mobile charging unit were installed in the co-operative in 2012 under TERI's Lighting a Billion Lives project. The co-operative earns ₹ 5 for a charging duration; the income from this project is already double the cost invested.

With permission from the village Dorbar, the co-operative implements its activities on community land. The co-operative protects members and other farmers by purchasing produce from them at support prices and releases them from the oppressive market prices. This also frees members from going to the markets, and saves them valuable time. The co-operative employs four men and one woman with regular salary.

PROFILE

Name	:	Umngot Multipurpose Cooperative Society Ltd. Siangkhnai, Mawkynrew Block, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	2009
Membership	:	Male 13 Female 10 Total 23
Chairman	:	Smt. D. Suting
Secretary	:	Shri. K.S. Suting
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 2,60,000
Business Turnover	:	₹ 5,00,262
Working Result	:	₹ 1,916

MENDIPATHAR MULTIPURPOSE COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Mendipathar Multipurpose Co-operative (MMCS) was registered in 1998, with its headquarters at Mendipathar, East Garo Hills, to empower marginal farmers through Information, education, knowledge, and skills training; generate economic empowerment through agriculture, farming and marketing. Marketing of farm produce like rubber, black pepper, corn, turmeric, and others by MMCS has freed people from the manipulation of money lenders and middle men. All items in their consumer shop are sold at less than MRP. All the farm produce are bought at a price that is fair and reasonable to farmers. Thrift-saving is encouraged and the co-operative received ₹ 57.5 lakh in deposits in 2010-11.

The co-operative collaborates closely in implementing government schemes like Community Led Total Sanitation and social audit of Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme. MMCS has also implemented IFAD and NABARD projects, especially in creating Self-Help Groups. They have formed 153 SHGS.

MMCS is conscious of climate-change, the need to protect the environment, and careful use of non-renewable energy. People are encouraged in the practice of organic farming, bio-gas use, recycling of waste, and judicious water and electricity use. They have a model farm at Jampara village where people given exposure, and training.

The co-operative has dealt in essential commodities like consumer goods, stationery, utensils, clothes and the like since 2000. They started poultry farming in 2003. In 2008, the co-operative started dairy farming with the objective to provide pure milk at cheaper rates than the market.

The society also provides fax, computer print, photocopy, lamination, color passport photography, atta chakki, and rice mill services to the community. They also rent out their community hall, plastic chairs, water pumps, vehicles and power tiller at reasonable rates.

PROFILE

Name	:	Mendipathar Multipurpose Cooperative Society Ltd. Mendipathar, East Garo Hills
Year of Formation	:	1999
Membership	:	Male 182 Female 78 Total 260
Chairman	:	Shri. F. Arengh
Secretary	:	Sr. Rose Kayathinkara
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 56,02,900
Business Turnover	:	₹ 7,08,37,085
Working Result	:	₹ 9,73,586

POMLUM MULTIPURPOSE COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Pomlum Multipurpose Co-operative Society in Pomlum, East Khasi Hills, was started with the aim to engage artisans and crafts-persons towards socio-economic development. The co-operative is involved in handcrafting items from cane, bamboo, wood, dry flowers into decorative pieces. It began with three members who contributed share capital to procure handicraft from local artisans to be sold at a profit, in a bid to fight poverty in their community. They eventually realised that these attempts were inadequate, and a concerted effort for crop cultivation with the larger community was necessary. They began enrolling young artisans and local crafts-persons into a co-operative that was registered in 2009.

The co-operative runs a successful business operation, engaging five artisan members on a regular basis. Their business includes handicraft made by co-operative members, dry-flower pieces handcrafted in the co-operative, procurement and sale of handicraft from non-members in the area, as well as from artisans in Mawsynram. They frequently participate in handicraft exhibitions where their products are in-demand. They also sell their products outside the state and at tourist destinations like Cherrapunjee. The co-operative has a show room for its handicraft products at Pomlum Village, Upper Shillong.

Keeping in mind their goal to combat poverty in their village in general, they diversified their activities in 2010. The co-operative has a farm at Sohiong, where fishery, piggery, poultry and other agricultural pursuits have been taken up, staffed with regular employees. They occasionally even organise fishing competitions to engage the larger community. The co-operative provides loans amounting to ten thousand rupees to individual members for crop cultivation, availed through the Meghalaya Cooperative Apex Bank's Kissan Credit Card Scheme.

There are currently seventeen members in the co-operative, with ten men and seven women who stay focussed on their ultimate goal of poverty reduction in their community.

PROFILE

Name	:	Pomlum Multipurpose Cooperative Society Ltd. Pomlum, 7th Mile, Upper Shillong, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	2009
Membership	:	Male 10 Female 7 Total 17
Chairman	:	Shri. B. Lyngdoh
Secretary	:	Smt. D. Wankhar
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 3,400
Business Turnover	:	₹ 8,50,176
Working Result	:	₹ 9,808

THE MEGHALAYA CO-OPERATIVE APEX BANK LTD.
SHILLONG MAIN BRANCH
(A GOVERNMENT OF MEGHALAYA SPONSORED BANK)
Cooperatives

Apex
COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES
and Urban Banks

THE MEGHALAYA CO-OPERATIVE APEX BANK (MCAB) LTD.

The Meghalaya Co-operative Apex Bank (MCAB) was established in 1971 with one branch at Shillong, another at Tura. Today, the Bank has a wide network of forty-six branches across the state, providing effective banking and related services to the general public. In keeping with progresses in the Banking Sector, all its branches have been computerised, providing banking services through Core Banking Solution with NIC, New Delhi as the implementing agency.

It has a crucial role in the promotion and strengthening of cooperatives, serving the needs of rural development and target groups through affiliated Cooperative Societies and implementing special schemes like Integrated Village Development Scheme for all-round development of rural areas; With a view to encourage thrift saving among people, it offers 0.25 % more interest than Commercial / Public Sector Banks.

The Bank's diversified loan portfolios cater to credit requirements for agriculture and allied agriculture, procurement and marketing, consumer goods dealing, handloom and weaving, housing, transport, consumer durables, tourism development and other economic activities under farm and non-farm sectors. A Mobile Banking System was introduced in rural East Khasi Hills, with further efforts to increase its outreach in villages. To assist educated unemployed youth, the Bank launched a credit scheme for self employment on easy terms.

With the introduction of the Micro Credit Programme, it has enrolled itself as a Self Help Promotional Institution. The Bank is also the State Channelising Agency for National Handicapped Finance and Development Corporation and has financed fifty-two beneficiaries.

To support fish production, reduce the demand-supply gap, and generate employment in rural areas, a Fishery Finance scheme has been initiated under 'Aquaculture Development 1000 Ponds' launched by the state government.

It is the first State Cooperative Bank in the country to open Women Branches; it has also started a Women's Development Cell.

PROFILE

Name	:	Meghalaya Cooperative Apex Bank Ltd., Shillong, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1978

Membership :	Individual	Societies	State Govt.	Govt. of India	Others	Total
	8172	494	1	1	431	9099

Chairman	:	Shri. W. K. Kyndiah
Secretary	:	Shri. D. F. War
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 5,79,93,500
Business Turnover	:	₹ 57,00,36,785
Working Result	:	₹ 11,17,81,789

PROFILE

Name	:	Meghalaya State Housing Financing Cooperative Society Ltd., Shillong, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1976
Membership	:	Male 150 Female 123 Total 273
Chairman	:	Shri. P. C. Chakraborty
Secretary	:	Shri. L. R. Marak
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 4,09,06,702
Business Turnover	:	₹ 35,02,574
Working Result	:	(-) ₹ 4,58,764

MEGHALAYA STATE HOUSING FINANCING COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LTD.

The Meghalaya State Housing Financing Cooperative Society located at Nongrim Hills, Shillong was registered in 1976 with the purpose to extend advances and loan services to Primary Housing Cooperative Societies for the construction of residential houses, repairs, addition or renovation and improvement of existing houses. The Federation has 33 member Societies including the Government.

After a period of inactivity, efforts are being made to turn around the co-operative into a viable service oriented, self sustaining, and profit generating one with a spin off effect that would percolate to the Primary Housing Cooperative Societies in the state. The present Management of this Apex Housing Society has turned the Housing Cooperative around into an effective instrument of Socio Economic service.

Various amendments were made aimed at maximizing the income generating capacity of Apex Housing Society by taking up immediate viable construction works, making optimal and full use of their own land in the Housing Complex at Nongrim Hills, Shillong and other places, and the judicious utilization of financial assistance received from the State Government. The Management decided not to sanction any further loans to the members of Primary Housing Cooperative Society, but would instead take up construction of housing/trade centres according to the requirements of the primary Housing Societies that have their own land. They also provided a Voluntary Retirement scheme to three employees in 2009 to reduce management costs.

The benefits of Cooperative Housing are of particular relevance, especially, for the lower strata of the society where there is a growing need for proper shelter. The Apex Housing Society through their amendments has ushered in changes; with better understanding of housing needs of people from the lowest strata of society, they serve public needs better.

PROFILE

Name	:	Shillong Cooperative Urban Bank Ltd., Shillong, East Khasi Hills
Year of Formation	:	1965
Membership	:	Male 2127 Female 1939 Total 4066
Chairman	:	Shri. D. P. Wahlang, I.A.S
Secretary	:	Smt. J. Wankhar
Total Share Capital	:	₹ 2,85,05,725
Business Turnover	:	₹ 3,42,52,051
Working Result	:	₹ 97,851

SHILLONG COOPERATIVE URBAN BANK LTD.

The Shillong Cooperative Urban Bank is one of the oldest banks in the state having, been established in the year 1965. The early years were not easy for the bank, but today it is considered as vibrant and efficient as other top banks in the state. With a CD ratio of over 57 percent and gross non-performing asset of 3.5 percent, it ranks in the top bracket amongst the major big banks. Further, its net worth (CRAR) is well over 20 percent. Most of all, the bank is considered to be customer friendly, where every individual customer is offered quality service and treated on a personal level. The customers are attended to promptly and efficiently, and their work is completed in the shortest time possible.

The Bank has three branches - the Shillong Main Branch, the Polo Branch and the Rynjah Branch with another two branches in the pipeline.

The Bank's main objective is to serve the urban poor of the state of Meghalaya especially in the city of Shillong. Besides catering to the business community, the Bank is extending credit facilities to salaried Government Employees, and employees in the corporate sector, in the form of housing loans, personal loans, vehicle loans and the like. The bank also offers facilities like RTGS and cheques at par through its association with Axis Bank. Being a government sponsored bank, all depositors' deposits are insured under DICGC.

The Bank offers a high interest rate at 5.25 percent per annum on Savings Deposits and the cheapest interest rates on any type of loan; so much so that many individuals have approached the bank for their credit needs. The bank's aim is to serve the middle and the lower income groups in the urban areas of Shillong.

MEGHALAYA COOPERATIVES - KEY STATISTICS (AS ON 31.3.2012)

Sl. No.	Name of Societies	Number of Societies	Membership strength	Total Paid-up Share Capital (Amount ₹. in lakhs)	Working Capital (Amount ₹. in lakhs)	No. of societies making profit	No. of societies incurring loss
	APEX LEVEL						
1	Meghalaya Cooperative Apex Bank Ltd.	1	9,099	579.94	1,45,392.22	1	
2	Meghalaya State Cooperative Marketing & Consumers' Federation Ltd.	1	199	2,037.29	95.00		1
3	Meghalaya State Housing Financing Cooperative Society Ltd.	1	273	409.07	383.21		1
4	Meghalaya Apex Handloom & Handicrafts Cooperative Federation Ltd.	1	61	200.11	87.66		1
5	Meghalaya State Cooperative Union Ltd.	1	259	0.15	75.75		1
	PRIMARY LEVEL						
6	Cooperative Urban Bank	3	13,467	544.13	12,701.96	3	0
7	Wholesale Cooperative Store	2	244	58.60	136.93	1	1
8	Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS)	179	88,908	762.63	3,478.86	86	93
9	Housing	13	1,173	7.34	346.53	6	7
10	Marketing	26	1,179	136.58	261.79	17	9
11	Consumer	49	9,011	163.58	344.35	32	17
12	Multipurpose	460	11,241	582.31	2,143.59	279	181

13	Thrift	61	15,238	439.78	9,793.50	45	16
14	Industrial	106	2,471	116.22	190.16	40	66
15	District Milk Cooperative Union	3	38	2.14	3.26	3	0
16	Dairy	94	2,776	97.55	176.64	53	41
17	Fisheries	69	2,433	94.75	242.36	32	37
18	Handloom Weavers	70	4,026	153.33	221.42	21	49
19	Handicraft	9	255	12.02	14.80	5	4
20	Transport	74	3,436	171.93	473.32	37	37
21	Joint / Collective Farming	26	732	16.44	27.95	11	15
22	Livestock	81	1,675	107.79	165.17	46	35
23	Horticulture	22	1,607	20.34	20.71	9	13
24	Processing	14	417	243.85	507.56	6	8
25	Labour Contract	8	260	6.88	5.14	4	4
26	Sericulture	6	308	2.99	6.74	2	4
27	Tourism	7	229	2.39	37.40	3	4
28	Other Types	4	123	5.62	18.10	1	3
	TOTAL	**1,391**	**1,71,138**	**6,975.75**	**1,77,352.08**	**743**	**648**

MEGHALAYA COOPERATIVES

Snapshots of
INTERNATIONAL YEAR OF COOPERATIVES 2012 CELEBRATION

A stall at the Regional Cooperative Expo, Shillong

Training programme of Women Cooperators at NIFT, Shillong

Cooperative Week Celebration at Mawkyrwat , West Khasi Hills

Distribution of solar lamps through the PrimaryAgricultural Credit Societies, Nongstoin

Cooperative Week Celebration at Khliehriat, East Jaintia Hills

2012 International Year of Cooperatives

Inauguration of Regional Cooperative Expo, Shillong

Participants at the Cane and Bamboo Workshop, NIFT, Shillong

Workshop on branding and packaging of Cooperative Products, Shillong

A cooperative society participating at the International Trade Fair, New Delhi

MEGHALAYA
COOPERATIVES